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Clock generation apparatus, clock generation method, adjustment apparatus, adjustment method, and non-transitory computer readable medium

Abstract

Provided is a clock generation apparatus which generates an output clock signal, comprising: a first voltage-controlled oscillator which outputs the output clock signal; an AD converter which includes: a second voltage-controlled oscillator which outputs an internal clock signal phase-locked to the output clock signal in response to a digital temperature signal having become a value corresponding to an analog temperature signal from a temperature sensor; a phase comparator which detects a phase difference between the output clock signal and the internal clock signal; and a digital temperature signal generator which generates a digital temperature signal according to the phase difference detected by the phase comparator, to output it to the second voltage-controlled oscillator; and a digital temperature compensation circuit which compensates a frequency of the output clock signal of the first voltage-controlled oscillator by using the digital temperature signal.

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Primary Examiner: Gannon; Levi

Background/Summary

(1) The contents of the following patent application(s) are incorporated herein by reference: NO. 2022-174144 filed in JP on Oct. 31, 2022

BACKGROUND

1. Technical Field

(2) The present invention relates to a clock generation apparatus, a clock generation method, an adjustment apparatus, an adjustment method, and a non-transitory computer readable medium.

2. Related Art

(3) Patent Document 1 describes a clock generator including: a resonator; a temperature sensor 151; a dual-path compensation signal generator 153; and a frequency compensator 155 (column 4, lines 26 to 40, FIG. 2). Column 9, line 17 to column 10, line 35 and FIGS. 6A to 6D describe the one using a phase-locked loop (PLL) as a frequency compensation circuit. Non-Patent Document 1 describes a temperature to digital converter (TEMPDC) which uses two MEMS resonators.

PRIOR ART DOCUMENT

Patent Document

(4) Patent Document 1: Specification of U.S. Pat. No. 10,594,301

Non-Patent Document

(5) Non-Patent Document 1: Meisam Heidarpour Roshan, and other 13 persons, “Dual-MEMS-Resonator Temperature-to-Digital Converter with 40 μ K Resolution and FOM of 0.12 pJK²”, 2016 IEEE International Solid-State Circuits Conference (ISSCC2016), Feb. 2, 2016

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 shows a configuration of a clock generation apparatus **1** according to the present embodiment.

(2) FIG. 2 shows a configuration of a TADC **230** according to the present embodiment.

(3) FIG. 3 shows a configuration of a second VCO **332** according to the present embodiment.

(4) FIG. 4A shows time waveforms for a case where an output clock signal is affected by an interference component with a half frequency.

(5) FIG. 4B shows a frequency spectrum for a case where an output clock signal is affected by an interference component with a half frequency.

(6) FIG. 5A shows time waveforms for a case where an output clock signal is affected by an interference component with a doubled frequency.

(7) FIG. 5B shows a frequency spectrum for a case where an output clock signal is affected by an interference component with a doubled frequency.

(8) FIG. 6 shows a configuration of a phase comparator **634** according to the present embodiment.

(9) FIG. 7 shows an example of operation waveforms of the phase comparator **634**.

(10) FIG. 8 shows a configuration of a phase comparator **834** according to a modified example.

(11) FIG. 9 shows a configuration of a loop filter **936** according to the present embodiment.

- (12) FIG. **10** shows a configuration of a loop filter **1036** according to a modified example.
- (13) FIG. **11** shows a configuration of a digital temperature compensation circuit **1135** according to the present embodiment.
- (14) FIG. **12** shows a configuration of a linearity correction circuit **1240** according to the present embodiment.
- (15) FIG. **13** shows a configuration of a polynomial circuit **1342** according to the present embodiment.
- (16) FIG. **14** shows a configuration of a polynomial circuit **1442** according to a modified example.
- (17) FIG. **15** shows a setting for each temperature zone in the polynomial circuit **1442**.
- (18) FIG. **16** shows an example of a frequency error characteristic of the clock generation apparatus **1**.
- (19) FIG. **17** shows an example of a frequency error characteristic after digital temperature compensation.
- (20) FIG. **18** shows a configuration of a polynomial circuit **1842** according to a modified example.
- (21) FIG. **19** shows an example of a frequency error characteristic after digital temperature compensation with an LUT.
- (22) FIG. **20** shows a configuration of a TADC **2030** according to a modified example.
- (23) FIG. **21** shows a configuration of a TADC **2130** according to another modified example.
- (24) FIG. **22** shows a configuration of a TADC **2180** according to yet another modified example.
- (25) FIG. **23** shows a configuration of an adjustment apparatus **2310** according to the present embodiment.
- (26) FIG. **24** shows an adjustment flow of a clock generation apparatus **2301** by the adjustment apparatus **2310** according to the present embodiment.
- (27) FIG. **25** shows a current DAC adjustment flow of the clock generation apparatus **2301** by the adjustment apparatus **2310** according to the present embodiment.
- (28) FIG. **26** shows an example of linearity of digital temperature signals.
- (29) FIG. **27** shows a linearity correction circuit adjustment flow of the clock generation apparatus **2301** by the adjustment apparatus **2310** according to the present embodiment.
- (30) FIG. **28A** shows an example of a frequency error characteristic of a digital temperature signal.
- (31) FIG. **28B** shows an example of a frequency error characteristic of a digital temperature signal after linearity correction.
- (32) FIG. **29** shows a VDAC adjustment flow of the clock generation apparatus **2301** by the adjustment apparatus **2310** according to the present embodiment.
- (33) FIG. **30** shows a compensation function adjustment flow of the clock generation apparatus **2301** by the adjustment apparatus **2310** according to the present embodiment.
- (34) FIG. **31** shows an example of a frequency error characteristic after digital temperature compensation.
- (35) FIG. **32A** shows an example of a frequency temperature slope after digital temperature compensation.
- (36) FIG. **32B** shows an example of a frequency temperature slope after digital temperature compensation for a case where a compensation function is decided by overlapping each zone.
- (37) FIG. **33** shows an example of a computer **2200** in which a plurality of aspects of the present invention may be entirely or partially embodied.

DESCRIPTION OF EXEMPLARY EMBODIMENTS

(38) Hereinafter, the present invention will be described through embodiments of the invention, but the following embodiments do not limit the invention according to claims. In addition, not all of the combinations of features described in the embodiments are essential to the solution of the invention.

(39) FIG. **1** shows a configuration of a clock generation apparatus **1** according to the present embodiment. The clock generation apparatus **1** generates and output an output clock signal

XOCLK. The clock generation apparatus **1** outputs a clock signal generated by a first voltage-controlled oscillator (first VCO) **120** as an output clock signal, and sets an operation frequency of another circuit in the clock generation apparatus **1** to an integer multiple (integer multiple by an integer of one or two or more) of that of the output clock signal, thereby suppressing noise interference to the output clock signal.

(40) The clock generation apparatus **1** includes a resonator **105**, the first voltage-controlled oscillator (first VCO) **120**, a temperature sensor **125**, a temperature analog-to-digital converter (TADC) **130**, a digital temperature compensation circuit **135**, a voltage digital-to-analog converter (VDAC) **140**, and a low pass filter (LPF) **145**. The first VCO **120** is also referred to as a voltage-controlled crystal oscillator (VCXO) if it oscillates with a crystal resonator. The resonator **105** is a resonator (vibrator) such as the crystal resonator, a MEMS resonator, or a langasite type resonator.

(41) The first VCO **120** generates the output clock signal by using the resonator **105**, to output it to an apparatus, a circuit, or the like external to the clock generation apparatus **1**. The first VCO **120** changes a frequency of the output clock signal depending on a control voltage inputted from the LPF **145**. The clock generation apparatus **1** maintains the frequency of the output clock signal outputted by the first VCO **120** at a target frequency independent of temperature, by adjusting the control voltage according to temperature.

(42) The temperature sensor **125** measures temperature of the clock generation apparatus **1**, to output an analog temperature signal according to the temperature of the clock generation apparatus **1**. The temperature sensor **125** may be provided in a housing of the clock generation apparatus **1**, to measure temperature in the housing. In addition, the clock generation apparatus **1** may be provided near the resonator **105**, to measure temperature of the resonator **105**.

(43) The TADC **130** is connected to the first VCO **120** and the temperature sensor **125**. The TADC **130** is an example of an AD converter, and is also referred to as a temperature to digital converter (TEMPDC). The TADC **130** converts the analog temperature signal from the temperature sensor **125** to a digital temperature signal.

(44) The digital temperature compensation circuit **135** is connected to the first VCO **120** and the TADC **130**. The digital temperature compensation circuit **135** compensates the frequency of the output clock signal of the first VCO **120** by using the digital temperature signal from the TADC **130**. In the present embodiment, the digital temperature compensation circuit **135** generates a digital temperature compensation signal for compensating the frequency of the output clock signal, by digitally processing the digital temperature signal.

(45) The VDAC **140** is connected to the digital temperature compensation circuit **135**. The VDAC **140** converts the digital temperature compensation signal from the digital temperature compensation circuit **135**, to output it as an analog temperature compensation signal.

(46) The LPF **145** is connected to the VDAC **140**. The LPF **145** outputs, to the first VCO **120**, the control voltage obtained by low-pass filtering the analog temperature compensation signal from the VDAC **140**. The first VCO **120** inputs the control voltage according to the analog temperature compensation signal, to adjust the frequency of the output clock signal.

(47) The clock generation apparatus **1** may further include any combination of an adjustment data storage unit **150**, an analog temperature compensation circuit **160**, or an oven control circuit **170**. The adjustment data storage unit **150** stores adjustment data for adjusting at least one of the TADC **130**, the digital temperature compensation circuit **135**, or the VDAC **140**. In response to a power supply being turned on, the clock generation apparatus **1** reads out, from the adjustment data storage unit **150**, respective adjustment parameters of the TADC **130**, the digital temperature compensation circuit **135**, and the VDAC **140**, to be set in the TADC **130**, the digital temperature compensation circuit **135**, and the VDAC **140**.

(48) The analog temperature compensation circuit **160** is connected to the temperature sensor **125**. The analog temperature compensation circuit **160** compensates the frequency of the output clock signal of the first VCO **120** according to the analog temperature signal from the temperature sensor

125. In the example of the present figure, the first VCO **120** receives the control voltage in which the analog temperature compensation signal obtained by converting the digital temperature compensation signal from the digital temperature compensation circuit **135** to analog by the VDAC **140** and a second analog temperature compensation signal generated by the analog temperature compensation circuit **160** are divided by a resistor R_{dc} and a resistor R_{ac} and low-pass filtered. (49) The analog temperature compensation circuit **160** suppresses a frequency error of the output clock signal to, for example, approximately $\frac{1}{2}$ or less. As a result, the digital temperature compensation circuit **135** can compensate the frequency error of the output clock signal, which remains even after temperature compensation by the analog temperature compensation circuit **160**. As a result, if the clock generation apparatus **1** includes the analog temperature compensation circuit **160**, the digital temperature compensation circuit **135** can reduce a range of a digital compensation component to improve resolution of the digital compensation component. In addition, the clock generation apparatus **1** can reduce a gain of noise from the digital temperature compensation circuit **135** to be transmitted to **120**, and can reduce the noise of the output clock signal.

(50) In addition, the digital temperature compensation circuit **135** has a high degree of freedom in the temperature compensation through digital processing, and can generate the compensation component which fits even the frequency error steep with respect to a temperature change. On the other hand, in the digital temperature compensation circuit **135**, quantization noise may be mixed into the output clock signal due to the digital processing. In contrast, the analog temperature compensation circuit **160** may hardly generate the compensation component which fits the frequency error steep with respect to the temperature change, but is free of quantization noise. When including both the digital temperature compensation circuit **135** and the analog temperature compensation circuit **160**, the clock generation apparatus **1** can generate the output clock signal with a small frequency error and little noise by compensating most of the frequency error with the analog temperature compensation circuit **160** and compensating the rest of the frequency error including the frequency error steep with respect to the temperature change with the digital temperature compensation circuit **135**.

(51) If the clock generation apparatus **1** includes the oven control circuit **170**, the resonator **105** is arranged in an oven **100** together with a temperature sensor **110** and a heater **115**. Here, the resonator **105** may be provided outside a semiconductor chip containing the TADC **130**, the digital temperature compensation circuit **135**, and the like. Such a semiconductor chip may further contain at least one of the first VCO **120**, the VDAC **140**, the LPF **145**, the adjustment data storage unit **150**, or the analog temperature compensation circuit **160**, or some of these components.

(52) The oven **100** seals a space in which the resonator **105**, the temperature sensor **110**, and the heater **115** are arranged, so that temperature of this space can be maintained at constant temperature. The temperature sensor **110** is arranged near the resonator **105**, and measures the temperature of the resonator **105**. The temperature sensor **110** may be provided separately from the temperature sensor **125**, or may be used as the temperature sensor **125**. The heater **115** is arranged near the resonator **105**, and heats the resonator **105**.

(53) The oven control circuit **170** is connected to the oven **100**. The oven control circuit **170** controls the temperature of the resonator **105** in the oven **100** to be kept constant. The oven control circuit **170** has a resonator temperature detector **175**, a target temperature signal generator **180**, a differential amplifier **190**, and a heater driving circuit **195**.

(54) The resonator temperature detector **175** is connected to the temperature sensor **110**. The resonator temperature detector **175** detects the analog temperature signal from the temperature sensor **110**. The resonator temperature detector **175** may output a voltage according to the analog temperature signal. The target temperature signal generator **180** generates a target temperature signal indicating target temperature of the resonator **105**. The target temperature of the resonator **105** may be temperature higher than normal temperature, such as, for example, 110 degrees C. The

target temperature signal generator **180** may output a voltage according to the target temperature as the target temperature signal.

(55) The differential amplifier **190** is connected to the resonator temperature detector **175** and the target temperature signal generator **180**. The differential amplifier **190** amplifies and outputs a difference (for example, voltage difference) between the analog temperature signal from the resonator temperature detector **175** and the target temperature signal from the target temperature signal generator **180**. The heater driving circuit **195** is connected to the differential amplifier **190**. The heater driving circuit **195** allows a current according to the difference between the analog temperature signal and the target temperature signal to flow through the heater **115**. The heater driving circuit **195**, which may be a MOSFET, may be turned off and not allow the current to flow through the heater **115** if the temperature indicated by the analog temperature signal is higher than the temperature indicated by the target temperature signal, and may be turned on and allow the current to flow through the heater **115** if the temperature indicated by the analog temperature signal is lower than the temperature indicated by the target temperature signal. In addition, if priority is given to current consumption and area reduction, the clock generation apparatus **1** may not include the oven control circuit **170**, the heater **115**, and the temperature sensor **110**.

(56) FIG. 2 shows a configuration of a TADC **230** according to the present embodiment. The clock generation apparatus **1** may use the TADC **230** shown in the present figure as the TADC **130**, or may use another TADC. The TADC **230** has a second voltage-controlled oscillator (second VCO) **232**, a phase comparator **234**, and a loop filter **236**.

(57) The second VCO **232** outputs an internal clock signal (VCOCLK). The second VCO **232** may generate the internal clock signal by using a phase-locked loop (PLL) being as the entire TADC **230**. The second VCO **232** outputs such an internal clock signal as will be phase-locked to an output clock signal in response to a digital temperature signal having become a value corresponding to an analog temperature signal from the temperature sensor **125**.

(58) The phase comparator **234** is connected to the second VCO **232**. The phase comparator **234** detects a phase difference between the output clock signal (XOCLK) from the first VCO **120** and the internal clock signal, to output a phase difference signal according to the phase difference.

(59) The loop filter **236** is connected to the phase comparator **234**. The loop filter **236** functions as a digital temperature signal generator, and filters the phase difference signal, thereby generating the digital temperature signal according to the phase difference detected by the phase comparator **234**. Here, filtering processing may include time integral processing of an input signal. Accordingly, the loop filter **236** may perform filtering which involves a time integral on the phase difference signal, and in this case, the loop filter **236** may generate the digital temperature signal according to the time integral of the phase difference detected by the phase comparator **234**. In addition, the loop filter **236** filters the phase difference signal, thereby generating a feedback signal according to the phase difference detected by the phase comparator **234**, to supply it to the second VCO **232**. Since a signal obtained by applying conversion such as filtering to the phase difference signal in this manner is an example of a signal based on the phase difference signal, and is according to the phase difference, it can be regarded as a kind of the phase difference signal. In the example of the present figure, the loop filter **236** supplies the digital temperature signal to the second VCO **232** as the feedback signal. As a result, the second VCO **232** outputs the internal clock signal with a frequency according to the analog temperature signal and the phase difference detected by the phase comparator.

(60) In the TADC **230** described above, a phase of the internal clock signal outputted by the second VCO **232** will be locked to a phase of the output clock signal under feedback control from the digital temperature signal via the PLL. If an analog temperature signal input to the second VCO **232** changes in this state, the PLL changes the digital temperature signal instead to maintain a phase lock state of the internal clock signal. That is, the TADC **230** converts an amount of change in the analog temperature signal to an amount of change in the digital temperature signal (both are

the same amount of change in terms of temperature). In this manner, the TADC **230** functions as an analog-to-digital converter which outputs the digital temperature signal corresponding to the analog temperature signal.

(61) Note that, in the example of the present figure, a frequency of the internal clock signal is adjusted to a frequency of the output clock signal. If the frequency of the internal clock signal is adjusted to a frequency equivalent to an integer multiple of the frequency of the output clock signal by an integer equal to or greater than two, the TADC **230** may include a frequency divider which divides a frequency by an integer divide ratio and is placed between the second VCO **232** and the phase comparator **234**, and may divide the internal clock signal with the frequency divider.

Alternatively, the TADC **230** may not have the frequency divider as described above even if the internal clock signal has the frequency equivalent to the integer multiple of the frequency of the output clock signal by an integer equal to or greater than two, and may perform phase comparison of edges of the output clock signal and the internal clock signal for each cycle of the output clock signal with the phase comparator **234**. Specifically, if the frequency of the internal clock signal is N times (N is an integer equal to or greater than 1) the frequency of the output clock signal, no matter whether N is 1, 2, 3, . . . , a frequency at which an output value of the phase comparator **234** is updated is the same as the frequency of the output clock signal. Accordingly, regardless of a value of N, the output value of the phase comparator **234** does not change, and it is possible to realize a state in which the phase of the internal clock signal is locked to the phase of the output clock signal. Therefore, the TADC **230** does not need to include a frequency divider which divides a frequency by a divide ratio of N and is placed between the second VCO **232** and the phase comparator **234**, if it includes a second VCO which is restricted to output the internal clock signal at a frequency within a range greater than (N-1) times and less than (N+1) times the frequency of the output clock signal, or if it separately includes a circuit for controlling the frequency of the internal clock signal to be close to N times the frequency of the output clock signal.

(62) FIG. **3** shows a configuration of a second VCO **332** according to the present embodiment. The clock generation apparatus **1** may use the second VCO **332** as a circuit in the TADC **130** or as the second VCO **232** in the TADC **230**. The second VCO **332** includes a ring oscillator **340** and a power supply current generator **350**.

(63) The ring oscillator **340** oscillates at a frequency according to a difference between temperature designated by an analog temperature signal from the temperature sensor **125** and temperature designated by a digital temperature signal. In the present embodiment, the ring oscillator **340** oscillates at a frequency according to a power supply current received from the power supply current generator **350**, to generate an internal clock signal (VCOCLK). In the example of the present figure, the ring oscillator **340** has a plurality of inverting delay elements (an odd number of inverting delay elements) connected in a ring form, and is inverted each time the internal clock signal passes through the plurality of inverting delay elements. Note that the ring oscillator **340** may include any number of non-inverting delay elements between the inverting delay elements. The ring oscillator **340** further increases a frequency of the internal clock signal because switching speed of each inverting delay element is higher as the power supply current inputted from the power supply current generator **350** is higher. The ring oscillator **340** further decreases the frequency of the internal clock signal, because the switching speed of each inverting delay element is lower as the power supply current inputted from the power supply current generator **350** is lower.

(64) In the present embodiment, the ring oscillator **340** outputs, as the internal clock signal, a polyphase internal clock signal having a plurality of phases with different phases. The ring oscillator **340** may output, as a clock signal VCK [k] ($k=K-1, \dots, 2, 1, 0$) for each phase of a polyphase clock signal, K clock signals outputted by every predetermined number (even number) of inverting delay elements among the plurality of inverting delay elements. As a result, the ring oscillator **340** can output the polyphase internal clock signal VCK [K-1:0] whose phase is shifted by the time required for a signal to pass through a predetermined number of inverting logical

elements. Note that the VCK [K-1:0] indicates a set of K signals of VCK [K-1], . . . VCK [2], VCK [1], VCK [0].

(65) The power supply current generator **350** supplies the ring oscillator **340** with the power supply current according to the analog temperature signal from the temperature sensor **125** and a phase difference detected by the phase comparator **234**. In the example of the present figure, the power supply current generator **350** inputs the digital temperature signal as a feedback signal according to a phase difference signal outputted by the phase comparator **234**, and supplies the ring oscillator **340** with the power supply current according to the difference between temperature designated by the analog temperature signal and temperature designated by the digital temperature signal.

(66) The power supply current generator **350** includes an FET **352**, a resistor Ra, a current DAC **354**, a differential amplifier **356**, and an FET **358**. The FET **352** and the resistor Ra are connected in series between a power supply and ground. The FET **352** may be a MOSFET, and adjusts a current flowing between main terminals (between a drain and a source) according to a voltage inputted to a control terminal (gate). The resistor Ra sets a node between the FET **352** and the resistor Ra to a voltage according to a current flowing through the resistor Ra (voltage=resistance value Ra×current).

(67) The current DAC **354** draws, from the FET **352**, and passes a current designated by a digital feedback signal (digital temperature signal). As a result, the resistor Ra allows a current to flow which is obtained by subtracting a current flowing through the current DAC **354** from a current flowing through the FET **352**. The differential amplifier **356** controls a voltage of the control terminal of the FET **352** according to a result of comparing a voltage of the node between the FET **352** and the resistor Ra with a voltage of the analog temperature signal. As a result, the differential amplifier **356** adjusts the current flowing through the FET **352** such that the voltage of the node between the FET **352** and the resistor Ra matches the voltage of the analog temperature signal.

(68) In the present embodiment, the analog temperature signal inputted to the second VCO **332** has a lower voltage as temperature increases and a higher voltage as the temperature decreases. For the same value of the digital temperature signal, the power supply current generator **350** allows a more current to flow through the FET **352**, to increase the voltage of the node between the FET **352** and the resistor Ra, as a value of the analog temperature signal increases (that is, as the temperature designated by the analog temperature signal decreases). In addition, for the same value of the analog temperature signal, the power supply current generator **350** increases an amount of current drawn by the current DAC **354**, to increase the current flowing through the FET **352**, as a value of the digital temperature signal increases (that is, as the temperature designated by the digital temperature signal increases). As a result, the power supply current generator **350** allows a current according to the difference between the temperature designated by the analog temperature signal and the temperature designated by the digital temperature signal, more specifically, a current according to a difference obtained by subtracting the temperature designated by the analog temperature signal from the temperature designated by the digital temperature signal to flow through the FET **352**.

(69) The plurality of FETs **358** are respectively provided corresponding to a plurality of inverting logical elements in the ring oscillator **340**, and respectively allow the power supply current proportional to the current flowing through the FET **352** to flow through the plurality of inverting logical elements. As a result, if the temperature designated by the digital temperature signal is higher than the temperature designated by the analog temperature signal, the power supply current generator **350** transiently increases the frequency of the internal clock signal above a reference frequency. However, this frequency increase is canceled out by a frequency decrease involved with a decrease in the digital temperature signal due to a feedback of the PLL, and finally, the state converges such that the temperature designated by the digital temperature signal matches the temperature designated by the analog temperature signal. Conversely, if the temperature designated by the digital temperature signal is lower than the temperature designated by the analog

temperature signal, the power supply current generator **350** transiently decreases the frequency of the internal clock signal below the reference frequency. However, that frequency decrease is canceled out by a frequency increase involved with an increase in the digital temperature signal due to the feedback of the PLL, and finally, the state converges such that the temperature designated by the digital temperature signal matches the temperature designated by the analog temperature signal. (70) FIG. 4A shows time waveforms for a case where an output clock signal is affected by an interference component with a half frequency.

(71) FIG. 4B shows a frequency spectrum for a case where an output clock signal is affected by an interference component with a half frequency. If a circuit in the clock generation apparatus **1** operates at a frequency ($\frac{1}{2}$) F_{out} equivalent to $\frac{1}{2}$ of a frequency F_{out} of the output clock signal, as shown in FIG. 4A, an edge for each period of the output clock signal (rising edge in FIG. 4A) is alternately affected by a rising edge and a falling edge of the interference component with the frequency ($\frac{1}{2}$) F_{out} , which increases or decreases a length of a clock period. As a result, as shown in FIG. 4B, the output clock signal is equivalent to that modulated at a modulation frequency ($\frac{1}{2}$) F_{out} , and spurious components with the frequency ($\frac{1}{2}$) F_{out} and a frequency ($\frac{3}{2}$) F_{out} are superimposed on a main component with the frequency F_{out} . Similarly, noise is superimposed on the output clock signal by the influence of the interference component having a frequency less than the frequency F_{out} .

(72) FIG. 5A shows time waveforms for a case where an output clock signal is affected by an interference component with a doubled frequency.

(73) FIG. 5B shows a frequency spectrum for a case where an output clock signal is affected by an interference component with a doubled frequency. If a circuit in the clock generation apparatus **1** operates at a frequency $2 \times F_{out}$ equivalent to twice the frequency F_{out} of the output clock signal, as shown in FIG. 5A, although an edge for each period of the output clock signal (rising edge and falling edge in FIG. 5A) is affected by a rising edge of the interference component with the frequency $2 \times F_{out}$, a clock period does not vary unless a frequency of the interference component varies. As a result, as shown in FIG. 5B, no spurious component is superimposed on the output clock signal even if there is the interference component with the frequency $2 \times F_{out}$. Similarly, no noise is superimposed on the output clock signal by the influence of the interference component having a frequency equivalent to an integer multiple (integer multiple by a positive integer) of the frequency F_{out} .

(74) Therefore, the second VCO **232** according to the present embodiment is adjusted to have a frequency equivalent to an integer multiple of a frequency of the output clock signal, and is configured to generate an internal clock signal phase-locked to the output clock signal in response to a digital temperature signal having become a value corresponding to an analog temperature signal from a temperature sensor. As a result, the clock generation apparatus **1** can prevent the internal clock signal from superimposing the spurious component on the output clock signal, to reduce noise superimposed on the output clock signal.

(75) In addition, the clock generation apparatus **1** according to the present embodiment outputs a clock signal from the first VCO **120** to an outside as the output clock signal of the clock generation apparatus **1**, and uses a clock signal from the second VCO **232** only in the clock generation apparatus **1**. Here, while a Q value (quality factor) of a MEMS resonator is, for example, about tens of thousands, a Q value of a VCO with a PLL containing an IC is, for example, about 10 even in a case of an LC tank type oscillator configuration which is considered to have good noise performance, and the VCO containing the IC has much worse noise performance than the VCO using the MEMS resonator or the like. Therefore, when using an oscillator which oscillates using the resonator **105** such as a crystal resonator or the MEMS resonator as the first VCO **120** and when using an oscillator which oscillates using the PLL as the second VCO **232**, the clock generation apparatus **1** can output, as the output clock signal, the clock signal from the first VCO **120** with low noise.

(76) FIG. 6 shows a configuration of a phase comparator **634** according to the present embodiment. The clock generation apparatus **1** may use the phase comparator **634** as a circuit in the TADC **130** or as the phase comparator **234** in the TADC **230**. The phase comparator **634** includes a plurality of flip-flops (FF) and a binary converter **640**.

(77) The plurality of FFs (FF5 to FF0 in the figure) respectively sample the polyphase internal clock signal VCK [5:0] at the timing of an output clock signal (for example, at a rising edge). Then, the plurality of FFs output a value Q [5:0] obtained by sampling the polyphase internal clock signal VCK [5:0]. In the present embodiment, the phase comparator **634** includes six FFs, but the number of FFs may be any number equal to or greater than two. The binary converter **640** is connected to the plurality of FFs, and converts the value Q [5:0] to a phase difference signal TDC [3:0].

(78) FIG. 7 shows an example of operation waveforms of the phase comparator **634**. The phase comparator **634** inputs the polyphase internal clock signal VCK [5:0] each of which is adjusted to have the same frequency as that of an output clock signal and whose phase is shifted by a predetermined phase difference. The plurality of FFs sample the polyphase internal clock signal VCK [5:0] at the timing of the output clock signal (XOCLK). In the example of the present figure, the plurality of FFs sample Q [5:0]=6'b001110 at the first rising edge of the output clock signal, Q [5:0]=6'b000111 at the second rising edge, Q [5:0]=6'b100011 at the third rising edge, and Q [5:0]=6'b110001 at the fourth rising edge. Note that 6'bXXXXXX indicates a value of "XXXXXX" in 6-bit binary number.

(79) The binary converter **640** converts the value Q [5:0] to the phase difference signal TDC [3:0] indicating a phase difference. In the example of the present figure, the binary converter **640** decides a value of the output TDC [3:0] according to a position of a digit whose value has changed from 0 to 1 when the value of each digit of the Q [5:0] is viewed from a higher-order bit. Note that the binary converter **640** identifies the digit whose value has changed from 0 to 1, considering bits of the Q [5:0] to be cyclic and considering a Q [0] to be a higher-order digit of the Q [5]. With the TDC [3:0] as 4'b0011 when Q [5:0]=6'b001110, it is indicated that the phase of the output clock signal XOCLK is +1.5 steps ahead of the phase of the internal clock signal VCOCLK (that is, the phase of the internal clock signal VCOCLK should be advanced by +1.5 steps). With the TDC [3:0] as 4'b0001 when Q [5:0]=6'b000111, the binary converter **640** indicates that the phase of the output clock signal XOCLK is +0.5 steps ahead of the phase of the internal clock signal VCOCLK. With the TDC [3:0] as 4'b1111 when Q [5:0]=6'b100011, the binary converter **640** indicates that the phase of the output clock signal XOCLK is -0.5 steps ahead of (0.5 steps behind) the phase of the internal clock signal VCOCLK. With the TDC [3:0] as 4'b1101 when Q [5:0]=6'b110001, the binary converter **640** indicates that the phase of the output clock signal XOCLK is -1.5 steps ahead of (1.5 steps behind) the phase of the internal clock signal VCOCLK. Note that, for the phase difference signal TDC [3:0] described above, one unit is 0.5 steps and a negative value is represented in complement representation of two.

(80) The phase comparator **634** performs digital phase comparison of the output clock signal and the internal clock signal as mentioned above, to output a digital phase difference signal TDC [5:0]. The second VCO **232** or the second VCO **332** receives a feedback signal (digital temperature signal) according to the phase difference signal TDC [5:0] via the loop filter **236**, receives a substantially high feedback signal to generally increase a frequency of the internal clock signal if the phase difference signal TDC [5:0] is positive, and receives a substantially low feedback signal to generally decrease the frequency of the internal clock signal if the phase difference signal TDC [5:0] is negative. As a result, the TADC **230** can adjust the frequency of the internal clock signal to have a frequency equivalent to an integer multiple of a frequency of the output clock signal, to phase-lock the internal clock signal to the output clock signal.

(81) As described above, the TADC **130** may be realized by the TADC **230**, and in this case, the TADC **230** converts an analog temperature signal from the temperature sensor **125** to the digital temperature signal by using the internal clock signal having the frequency equivalent to the integer

multiple of the frequency of the output clock signal. Here, assuming that an AD converter which directly converts a voltage of the analog temperature signal to a digital value is used as the TADC **130**, in order to reduce noise of the output clock signal, an AD converter with a resolution high enough to express the digital temperature signal must be operated at the frequency equivalent to the integer multiple of the frequency of the output clock signal. However, such a high-resolution AD converter is hardly operated at high speed, and hardly prevents spurious generation. For example, in case of a delta-sigma modulator type AD converter, the overall operation speed is controlled by operation speed of an analog integrator or a switched capacitor circuit sampling an analog voltage, which makes it difficult to operate the converter at the frequency equivalent to the integer multiple of the frequency of the output clock signal. In addition, for example, in case of a successive approximation register type (SAR type) AD converter, conversion operation will be performed M times in order to obtain an M-bit digital value through the successive approximation process. When this conversion operation is performed M times in synchronization with the output clock signal with the frequency F_{out} , a frequency component with frequency $(1/M) F_{out}$ is generated in the AD converter, and a spurious component is superimposed on the output clock signal. The TADC **230** can be realized without using such a high-speed and high-resolution AD converter by converting the analog temperature signal to the digital temperature signal with a PLL.

(82) FIG. **8** shows a configuration of a phase comparator **834** according to a modified example. The clock generation apparatus **1** may use the phase comparator **834** as a circuit in the TADC **130** or as the phase comparator **234** in the TADC **230**. Since the phase comparator **834** may be configured to include the phase comparator **634**, and the plurality of FFs and the binary converter **640** in the phase comparator **834** are similar to corresponding constituent members of the phase comparator **634**, description thereof will be omitted.

(83) The phase comparator **834** includes a lock detection circuit **842**, a frequency detection circuit **844**, a frequency comparison circuit **850**, and a selection circuit **862** in addition to the phase comparator **634** including the plurality of FFs and the binary converter **640**. The lock detection circuit **842** is connected to the binary converter **640**. The lock detection circuit **842** is an example of a determination circuit, and determines whether a phase difference detected by the phase comparator **634** has come out of a predetermined range.

(84) The lock detection circuit **842** samples a phase difference signal P [3:0] (which corresponds to the TDC [3:0] in FIG. **6**) outputted by the binary converter **640**, at the timing of the output clock signal (XOCLK). It is assumed that the phase difference signal P [3:0] is one of six kinds of values -2.5 , -1.5 , -0.5 , $+0.5$, $+1.5$, $+2.5$, and a predetermined range of a phase lock state is -1.5 , -0.5 , $+0.5$, $+1.5$. The lock detection circuit **842** determines that the internal clock signal (VCOCLK) is phase-locked to the output clock signal, in response to the phase difference signal P [3:0] falling within a range from -1.5 to $+1.5$ or to the phase difference signal P [3:0] falling within the range from -1.5 to $+1.5$ for a predetermined number (number of 2 or more) of cycles of the output clock signal. The lock detection circuit **842** determines that the internal clock signal is not phase-locked to the output clock signal, in response to the phase difference signal P [3:0] being out of the range from -1.5 to $+1.5$ or to the phase difference signal P [3:0] having come out of the range from -1.5 to $+1.5$ for the predetermined number (number of 2 or more) of cycles of the output clock signal.

(85) The frequency detection circuit **844** is connected to the lock detection circuit **842**. The frequency detection circuit **844** includes a counter **846** and a counter **848**, and detects frequencies of the output clock signal and the internal clock signal in response to the phase difference detected by the phase comparator **634** having come out of the predetermined range. Count values outputted by the counter **846** and the counter **848** are reset to 0 if the internal clock signal is phase-locked to the output clock signal (if a LOCK signal outputted by the lock detection circuit **842**=a RESET signal is 1). The counter **846** is incremented for each period of the internal clock signal if the internal clock signal is no more phase-locked to the output clock signal (the LOCK signal=the RESET signal is 0). The counter **848** is incremented for each period of the output clock signal if the

internal clock signal is no more phase-locked to the output clock signal (the LOCK signal=the RESET signal is 0). As a result, the counter **846** and the counter **848** measure the number of pulses per time (that is, frequency) of the internal clock signal and the output clock signal.

(86) Note that, if the internal clock signal is adjusted to have a frequency equivalent to an integer multiple of the frequency of the output clock signal by an integer equal to or greater than two, the counter **846** may receive the internal clock signal via a frequency divider which divides a frequency by an integer divide ratio, to perform count up. Alternatively, the frequency detection circuit **844** may multiply the count value outputted by the counter **848** by an integer multiple, to output the result to the frequency comparison circuit **850**.

(87) The frequency comparison circuit **850** is connected to the frequency detection circuit **844**. The frequency comparison circuit **850** compares the frequency of the internal clock signal with the frequency of the output clock signal (frequency equivalent to an integer multiple of the frequency of the output clock signal). The frequency comparison circuit **850** includes a comparator **852**, an amplifier **854**, a comparator **856**, an amplifier **858**, and an adder **860**. The comparator **852** determines whether the count value of the counter **846** is greater than the count value of the counter **848**, that is, whether the frequency of the internal clock signal is higher than the frequency equivalent to the integer multiple of the frequency of the output clock signal. The amplifier **854** performs amplification by multiplying a comparison result from the comparator **852** by -2.5 , to output a minimum value -2.5 of the phase difference signal if the frequency of the internal clock signal is higher than the frequency equivalent to the integer multiple of the frequency of the output clock signal.

(88) The comparator **856** determines whether the count value of the counter **846** is equal to or smaller than the count value of the counter **848**, that is, whether the frequency of the internal clock signal is equal to or lower than the frequency equivalent to the integer multiple of the frequency of the output clock signal. The amplifier **858** performs amplification by multiplying a comparison result from the comparator **856** by $+2.5$, to output a maximum value $+2.5$ of the phase difference signal if the frequency of the internal clock signal is equal to or lower than the frequency equivalent to the integer multiple of the frequency of the output clock signal. The adder **860** adds outputs of the amplifier **854** and the amplifier **858**, to output a phase difference signal FCOMP [3:0] indicating the minimum value -2.5 or the maximum value $+2.5$. This phase difference signal FCOMP [3:0] indicates an amount by which a phase of the internal clock signal is to be delayed (or advanced), in relatively changing the phase of the internal clock signal with respect to the output clock signal in order to match a frequency to the frequency equivalent to the integer multiple of the frequency of the output clock signal.

(89) The selection circuit **862** is connected to the binary converter **640** and the frequency comparison circuit **850**. The selection circuit **862** selects the phase difference (phase difference signal P [3:0]) detected by the phase comparator **634** in response to the phase difference detected by the phase comparator **634** falling within the predetermined range (phase-locked state). In addition, the selection circuit **862** selects the phase difference (phase difference signal FCOMP [3:0]) decided according to a result of comparing the frequency equivalent to the integer multiple of the frequency of the output clock signal with the frequency of the internal clock signal in response to the phase difference detected by the phase comparator **634** having come out of the predetermined range (non phase-locked state). The selection circuit **862** outputs the selected phase difference signal as the phase difference signal TDC [3:0].

(90) The clock generation apparatus **1** can, by using the phase comparator **834**, output the phase difference signal FCOMP [3:0] which changes the phase difference such that the frequencies of the internal clock signal and the output clock signal are brought closer while the internal clock signal is not phase-locked to the output clock signal, and output the phase difference signal P [3:0] which reduces the phase difference between the internal clock signal and the output clock signal when the internal clock signal is phase-locked to the output clock signal. The second VCO **232** receives an

analog temperature signal from the temperature sensor **125** and, via the loop filter **236**, the phase difference signal selected by the selection circuit **862**, and outputs the internal clock signal with a frequency according to the received phase difference. As a result, even if there is a large difference between the frequency of the internal clock signal and the frequency equivalent to the integer multiple of the frequency of the output clock signal, the clock generation apparatus **1** can adjust and phase-lock the frequencies of the internal clock signal and the output clock signal.

(91) FIG. **9** shows a configuration of a loop filter **936** according to the present embodiment. The clock generation apparatus **1** may use the loop filter **936** as the loop filter **236** in the TADC **230**. The loop filter **936** includes an amplifier **940**, a delay element **942**, an amplifier **944**, an integrator **946**, and an adder **948**.

(92) The amplifier **940** amplifies the phase difference signal TDC [3:0] with a gain G.sub.p. The delay element **942** is connected to the amplifier **940**. The delay element **942** samples a signal outputted by the amplifier **940**, at the timing of an output clock signal.

(93) The amplifier **944** amplifies the phase difference signal TDC [3:0] with a gain G.sub.l. The integrator **946** is connected to the amplifier **944**. The integrator **946** integrates a signal outputted by the amplifier **944**, at each timing of the output clock signal. The integrator **946** may add an output value of the amplifier **944** in a current cycle to an integrated value in the current cycle of the output clock signal, to obtain the integrated value in a next cycle. Alternatively, the integrator **946** may add the output value of the amplifier **944** in the current cycle to the integrated value in the current cycle of the output clock signal which has been attenuated through multiplication by a predetermined attenuation factor (positive factor less than 1.0), to obtain the integrated value in the next cycle.

(94) The adder **948** adds outputs of the delay element **942** and the integrator **946**, to output the result as a digital temperature signal and a feedback signal to the second VCO **232**. The loop filter **936** described above functions as a PI feedback circuit having: a proportional path including the amplifier **940** and the delay element **942**; and an integral path including the amplifier **944** and the integrator **946**.

(95) FIG. **10** shows a configuration of a loop filter **1036** according to a modified example. The clock generation apparatus **1** may use the loop filter **1036** as the loop filter **236** in the TADC **230**. The loop filter **1036** includes the amplifier **940**, the delay element **942**, the amplifier **944**, the integrator **946**, and the adder **948**, similarly to the loop filter **936**. As shown in the present figure, the loop filter **1036** may output a digital temperature signal from an intermediate node in the loop filter **1036** (an output node of the integrator **946** in the example of the present figure) instead of using, as the digital temperature signal as well, a feedback signal which is a final output of the loop filter **1036**.

(96) FIG. **11** shows a configuration of a digital temperature compensation circuit **1135** according to the present embodiment. The clock generation apparatus **1** may use the digital temperature compensation circuit **1135** as the digital temperature compensation circuit **135**. The digital temperature compensation circuit **1135** includes a linearity correction circuit **1140**, a polynomial circuit **1142**, and a delta-sigma modulator **1144**.

(97) The linearity correction circuit **1140** linearly corrects a digital temperature signal. The polynomial circuit **1142** is connected to the linearity correction circuit **1140**. The polynomial circuit **1142** outputs a signal obtained by performing polynomial transformation on the linearly corrected digital temperature signal. The delta-sigma modulator **1144** converts the signal outputted by the polynomial circuit **1142**, to output it as a digital temperature compensation signal. The delta-sigma modulator **1144** may be a delta-sigma converter such as a MASH-111, as an example.

(98) FIG. **12** shows a configuration of a linearity correction circuit **1240** according to the present embodiment. The clock generation apparatus **1** may use the linearity correction circuit **1240** as the linearity correction circuit **1140** in the digital temperature compensation circuit **1135**. The linearity correction circuit **1240** operates in synchronization with an output clock signal. The linearity

correction circuit **1240** includes a plurality of exponentiators **1250**, a plurality of amplifiers **1252**, and an adder **1254**. The plurality of exponentiators **1250** calculate a plurality of exponentiation values obtained by exponentiating a digital temperature signal with a plurality of orders (values obtained by raising the digital temperature signal to the first power, the second power, the third power, and the like). The plurality of amplifiers **1252** multiply the plurality of exponentiation values of the digital temperature signal by a plurality of gains (P1, P2, P3, and the like), respectively. The adder **1254** adds outputs of the plurality of amplifiers **1252**, to output the result as a corrected digital temperature signal.

(99) The linearity correction circuit **1240** shown in FIG. **12** outputs the digital temperature signal which has been linearly corrected by correcting the digital temperature signal with a cubic function. Alternatively, the linearity correction circuit **1240** may use an M-th order function of a different order as a correction function, or may use any function other than the M-th order function as the correction function. Note that the linearity correction circuit **1240** may use, as parameters (for example, the plurality of gains P.sub.1 to P.sub.3) of the correction function, one or more adjustment parameters included in adjustment data stored in the adjustment data storage unit **150**.

(100) FIG. **13** shows a configuration of a polynomial circuit **1342** according to the present embodiment. The clock generation apparatus **1** may use the polynomial circuit **1342** as the polynomial circuit **1142** in the digital temperature compensation circuit **1135**. The polynomial circuit **1342** converts a digital temperature signal to a digital temperature compensation signal in synchronization with an output clock signal. The polynomial circuit **1342** includes a plurality of exponentiators **1350**, a plurality of amplifiers **1352**, and an adder **1354**. The plurality of exponentiators **1350** calculate a plurality of exponentiation values obtained by exponentiating the digital temperature signal from the linearity correction circuit **1140** with a plurality of orders (values obtained by raising the digital temperature signal to the first power, the second power, . . . , the N-th power, and the like). The plurality of amplifiers **1352** multiply the plurality of exponentiation values of the digital temperature signal by a plurality of gains (G.sub.1, G.sub.2, . . . , G.sub.N, and the like), respectively. The adder **1354** adds outputs of the plurality of amplifiers **1352**, to output the result as the digital temperature compensation signal.

(101) The polynomial circuit **1342** shown in FIG. **13** converts the digital temperature signal to the digital temperature compensation signal with an N-th order function. The polynomial circuit **1342** may use the N-th order function of any order as a compensation function for temperature compensation, or may use any function other than the N-th order function as the compensation function. For example, the polynomial circuit **1342** may be replaced with a spline circuit which uses an N-th order spline function as the compensation function. Note that the polynomial circuit **1342** may use, as parameters (for example, the plurality of gains G.sub.1 to G.sub.N) of the compensation function, one or more adjustment parameters included in adjustment data stored in the adjustment data storage unit **150**.

(102) FIG. **14** shows a configuration of a polynomial circuit **1442** according to a modified example. The clock generation apparatus **1** may use the polynomial circuit **1442** instead of the polynomial circuit **1342** as the polynomial circuit **1142** in the digital temperature compensation circuit **1135**. The polynomial circuit **1442** converts a digital temperature signal to a digital temperature compensation signal by using a compensation function associated with each of a plurality of temperature zones into which a predetermined temperature range is divided. As a result, the digital temperature compensation circuit **1135** can compensate a frequency of an output clock signal by using the compensation function associated with each of the plurality of temperature zones.

(103) The polynomial circuit **1442** converts the digital temperature signal to the digital temperature compensation signal in synchronization with the output clock signal. The polynomial circuit **1442** includes the plurality of exponentiators **1350**, the plurality of amplifiers **1352**, the adder **1354**, a temperature zone selection circuit **1450**, a function generation circuit **1452**, and a temperature shift circuit **1454**. Since the plurality of exponentiators **1350**, the plurality of amplifiers **1352**, and the

adder **1354** are similar to the plurality of exponentiators **1350**, the plurality of amplifiers **1352**, and the adder **1354** in FIG. **13**, description thereof will be omitted except for the following differences.

(104) The temperature zone selection circuit **1450** selects a temperature zone to be used from among a plurality of temperature zones according to the digital temperature signal. The function generation circuit **1452** is connected to the temperature zone selection circuit **1450**. The function generation circuit **1452** generates a compensation function which uses a parameter according to the temperature zone selected by the temperature zone selection circuit **1450**. The function generation circuit **1452** in the present modified example supplies each of the plurality of amplifiers **1352** with a gain to be set in each of the plurality of amplifiers **1352** according to the selected temperature zone. In addition, the function generation circuit **1452** outputs a temperature shift amount by which the digital temperature signal should be shifted according to the selected temperature zone.

(105) The temperature shift circuit **1454** is connected to the function generation circuit **1452**. The temperature shift circuit **1454** shifts the digital temperature signal by the temperature shift amount received from the function generation circuit **1452**. As a result, no matter which temperature zone includes a temperature value indicated by the digital temperature signal, the temperature shift circuit **1454** can convert the digital temperature signal such that a minimum temperature value in the temperature zone is a reference value (for example, 0). This temperature shift operation eliminates a need to prepare a separate exponentiator **1350** for each temperature zone, and can prevent an increase in circuit area.

(106) The polynomial circuit **1442** generates the digital temperature compensation signal with the plurality of exponentiators **1350**, the plurality of amplifiers **1352**, and the adder **1354** by using the compensation function generated by the function generation circuit **1452**. The polynomial circuit **1442** controls a frequency of the output clock signal of the first VCO **120** by supplying the generated digital temperature compensation signal to the first VCO **120** via the VDAC **140** and the LPF **145**.

(107) FIG. **15** shows a setting for each temperature zone in the polynomial circuit **1442**. The function generation circuit **1452** outputs, by using this setting, a plurality of compensation gains and a temperature shift amount corresponding to the temperature zone selected by the temperature zone selection circuit **1450**. In the example of the present figure, a temperature compensation range of the clock generation apparatus **1** is from -40 degrees C. to $+105$ degrees C. The temperature compensation range of the clock generation apparatus **1** is divided into five temperature zones **1** to **5**.

(108) The temperature zone **1** ranges from -40 degrees C. to -11 degrees C. The temperature shift amount of 0 and the compensation gains $G_{\text{sub.11}}$, $G_{\text{sub.12}}$, $\dots$, $G_{\text{sub.1N}}$ of each order to be set in each amplifier **1352** are associated with the temperature zone **1**.

(109) The temperature zone **2** ranges from -11 degrees C. to $+18$ degrees C. The temperature shift amount of 29 and the compensation gains $G_{\text{sub.21}}$, $G_{\text{sub.22}}$, $\dots$, $G_{\text{sub.2N}}$ of each order to be set in each amplifier **1352** are associated with the temperature zone **2**. In the temperature zone **2**, the temperature shift circuit **1454** subtracts the temperature shift amount of 29 from temperature indicated by a digital temperature signal. For example, if the digital temperature signal takes a value being 0 at -40 degrees C. and increasing by 1 for each 1 degree C. increase in the temperature, the digital temperature signal is 29 at -11 degrees C. In this case, the temperature shift circuit **1454** converts -11 degrees C. in the temperature zone **2** to 0 by subtracting 29 from the digital temperature signal in the temperature zone **2**. The temperature shift circuit **1454** can convert minimum temperature in all temperature zones to the same reference value (for example, 0) by similarly shifting the digital temperature signal in another temperature zone.

(110) The temperature zone **3** ranges from $+18$ degrees C. to $+47$ degrees C. The temperature shift amount of 58 and the compensation gains $G_{\text{sub.31}}$, $G_{\text{sub.32}}$, $\dots$, $G_{\text{sub.3N}}$ of each order to be set in each amplifier **1352** are associated with the temperature zone **3**.

(111) The temperature zone **4** ranges from $+47$ degrees C. to $+76$ degrees C. The temperature shift

amount of 87 and the compensation gains G.sub.41, G.sub.42, . . . , G.sub.4N of each order to be set in each amplifier **1352** are associated with the temperature zone **4**.

(112) The temperature zone **5** ranges from +76 degrees C. to +105 degrees C. The temperature shift amount of 116 and the compensation gains G.sub.51, G.sub.52, . . . , G.sub.5N of each order to be set in each amplifier **1352** are associated with the temperature zone **5**.

(113) FIG. **16** shows an example of a frequency error characteristic of the clock generation apparatus **1**. The horizontal axis of a graph shown in the present figure represents temperature and the vertical axis represents a frequency error (ppm). If temperature compensation is not performed, the frequency error of the clock generation apparatus **1** may have many extreme values and inflection points within a temperature compensation range (from -40 degrees C. to +105 degrees C.) of the clock generation apparatus **1**. The polynomial circuit **1442** divides the temperature compensation range into a plurality of temperature zones to generate a compensation function associated with each temperature zone, thereby reducing the number of extreme values and inflection points included in an individual temperature zone to allow the compensation function of a lower order to be used to increase accuracy of the temperature compensation.

(114) FIG. **17** shows an example of a frequency error characteristic after digital temperature compensation. The horizontal axis of a graph shown in the present figure represents temperature, and the vertical axis represents a frequency error (ppb). When a compensation function is assigned to each of the temperature zones into which a temperature compensation range (from -40 degrees C. to +105 degrees C.) is divided as shown in FIG. **15**, the polynomial circuit **1442** can reduce the frequency error throughout the temperature compensation range.

(115) Here, when trying to perform temperature compensation for each temperature zone by dividing the temperature compensation range with an analog temperature compensation circuit, a compensation component of an adjacent temperature zone leaks out near a boundary of the temperature zone, which makes it difficult to perform accurate temperature compensation. The clock generation apparatus **1** can assign the compensation function to each of the temperature zones into which the temperature compensation range is divided, by generating a digital temperature compensation signal through digital processing by the polynomial circuit **1442** by using a digital temperature signal converted from analog to digital by the TADC **130**.

(116) FIG. **18** shows a configuration of a polynomial circuit **1842** according to a modified example. The clock generation apparatus **1** may use the polynomial circuit **1842** instead of the polynomial circuit **1342** and the polynomial circuit **1442** as the polynomial circuit **1142** in the digital temperature compensation circuit **1135**. The polynomial circuit **1842** controls a frequency of an output clock signal of the first VCO **120** by using a temperature compensation value stored in a lookup table, in response to a digital temperature signal indicating temperature of a boundary portion between temperature zones.

(117) The polynomial circuit **1842** includes a lookup table **1850** in addition to each member of the polynomial circuit **1442** shown in FIG. **14**. Since a function and a configuration of each member in the polynomial circuit **1842** which is assigned the same reference numeral as in the polynomial circuit **1442** are similar to those of a corresponding member in the polynomial circuit **1442**, description thereof will be omitted except for the following differences.

(118) The lookup table **1850** includes a storage region **1852** and a correction amount selection circuit **1854**. The storage region **1852** stores a frequency correction amount at temperature of a boundary portion between adjacent temperature zones in association with the temperature. The storage region **1852** stores the frequency correction amount in association with each of a plurality of (for example, L (L>2)) values of the digital temperature signal.

(119) The correction amount selection circuit **1854** is connected to the storage region **1852**. If a value of the digital temperature signal matches any temperature value in the storage region **1852**, the correction amount selection circuit **1854** outputs the frequency correction amount (temperature compensation value) associated with the temperature value. If the value of the digital temperature

signal does not match any temperature value in the storage region **1852**, the correction amount selection circuit **1854** outputs the frequency correction amount of 0.

(120) The adder **1354** adds outputs of the plurality of amplifiers **1352** and the frequency correction amount outputted by the correction amount selection circuit **1854**, to output the result as a digital temperature compensation signal. As a result, the polynomial circuit **1842** can control the frequency of the output clock signal by using the temperature compensation value stored in the lookup table **1850**, if the digital temperature signal is a certain value.

(121) Note that, in the polynomial circuit **1842** described above, the lookup table **1850** outputs the temperature compensation value being as an adjustment value to be added to a value of a compensation function which uses the plurality of exponentiators **1350** and the plurality of amplifiers **1352**. Alternatively, the polynomial circuit **1842** may disable the compensation function such as by disabling or zeroing outputs from the plurality of amplifiers **1352** at certain temperature registered in the storage region **1852**, and output, as a value of the digital temperature compensation signal, the temperature compensation value outputted by the lookup table **1850**.

(122) In addition, the lookup table **1850** described above stores a plurality of sets of the temperature and the frequency correction amount, and functions as an associative memory which outputs the frequency correction amount corresponding to the temperature indicated by the digital temperature signal. Alternatively, the lookup table **1850** may have a storage region addressed near a boundary of a temperature zone, and output, in response to the temperature indicated by the digital temperature signal being inputted as an address, the frequency correction amount stored in the address.

(123) FIG. **19** shows an example of a frequency error characteristic after digital temperature compensation with a lookup table (LUT). The horizontal axis of a graph shown in the present figure represents temperature, and the vertical axis represents a frequency error (ppb). In the present figure, a dashed line indicates the frequency error characteristic for a case where the lookup table is not used, which is the same as the frequency error characteristic in FIG. **17**. A solid line indicates the frequency error characteristic for a case where the lookup table is further used. The polynomial circuit **1842** can use a temperature compensation value stored in the lookup table **1850** if a digital temperature signal indicates temperature of a boundary portion between temperature zones, thereby reducing a frequency temperature slope in the boundary portion between the temperature zones to suppress discontinuity and reducing the frequency error.

(124) FIG. **20** shows a configuration of a TADC **2030** according to a modified example. The clock generation apparatus **1** may use the TADC **2030** instead of the TADC **230**. Since the TADC **2030** is a modified example of the TADC **230**, a member having a function and a configuration similar to those of the TADC **230** is assigned the same reference numeral as the reference numeral in the TADC **230**, and description thereof will be omitted except for the following differences.

(125) The TADC **2030** further includes a delta-sigma modulator **2038** in addition to each member of the TADC **230**. The delta-sigma modulator **2038** modulates, by delta-sigma modulation, a phase difference signal according to a phase difference between an output clock signal and an internal clock signal (or a signal based on the phase difference signal), to output it to the second VCO **232**.

(126) Since the second VCO **232** discretely responds to a digital feedback signal, in the TADC **230** which is not provided with the delta-sigma modulator **2038**, periodic operation involved with a discrete response of the second VCO **232** may cause a spurious peak in a frequency spectrum of a digital temperature signal. In the TADC **2030**, converting an output of the loop filter **236** with the delta-sigma modulator **2038** can spread spurious and reduce the spurious peak.

(127) FIG. **21** shows a configuration of a TADC **2130** according to another modified example. The clock generation apparatus **1** may use the TADC **2130** instead of the TADC **230**. Since the TADC **2130** is a modified example of the TADC **230**, a member having a function and a configuration similar to those of the TADC **230** is assigned the same reference numeral as the reference numeral in the TADC **230**, and description thereof will be omitted except for the following differences.

(128) The TADC **2130** further includes a dither application circuit **2140** in addition to each member of the TADC **230**. The dither application circuit **2140** applies dither to a phase difference signal according to a phase difference between an output clock signal and an internal clock signal (or a signal based on the phase difference signal), to output the signal to the second VCO **232**.

(129) As shown in connection with FIG. **20**, the TADC **230** may have a spurious peak generated in a frequency spectrum of a digital temperature signal. In the TADC **2130**, the dither application circuit **2140** applies the dither having a pseudo-random pattern to the phase difference signal filtered by the loop filter **236** (a signal based on the phase difference signal). The dither application circuit **2140** may be a circuit which uses a linear feedback shift register such as a Fibonacci linear feedback shift register (LFSR), as an example. In the TADC **2130**, applying the dither to an output of the loop filter **236** can spread a spurious generated in the digital temperature signal, and reduce the spurious peak.

(130) FIG. **22** shows a configuration of a TADC **2180** according to yet another modified example. The clock generation apparatus **1** may use the TADC **2180** instead of the TADC **230**. Since the TADC **2180** is a modified example of the TADC **230**, the TADC **2030**, and the TADC **2130**, a member having a function and a configuration similar to those of the TADC **230**, the TADC **2030**, and the TADC **2130** is assigned the same reference numeral as the reference numeral in the TADC **230**, the TADC **2030**, and the TADC **2130**, and description thereof will be omitted except for the following differences.

(131) The TADC **2180** includes both the delta-sigma modulator **2038** shown in FIG. **20** and the dither application circuit **2140** shown in FIG. **21** in addition to each member of the TADC **230**. As shown in connection with FIG. **20**, the delta-sigma modulator **2038** can suppress a spurious peak of a digital temperature signal. However, an output of the delta-sigma modulator **2038** may have a broad based idle tone involved with periodic operation for quantization by the delta-sigma modulator **2038**. The TADC **2180** can further include the dither application circuit **2140** in addition to the delta-sigma modulator **2038**, thereby spreading the idle tone generated by the delta-sigma modulator **2038**, to suppress the spurious peak due to the idle tone.

(132) FIG. **23** shows a configuration of an adjustment apparatus **2310** according to the present embodiment together with a clock generation apparatus **2301** and a temperature control apparatus **2305**. The clock generation apparatus **2301** may be one of the clock generation apparatuses **1** shown in FIG. **1** to FIG. **22**, or may be another clock generation apparatus. In the present embodiment, for explanatory convenience, description will be made taking as an example a case where the clock generation apparatus **2301** is the clock generation apparatus **1**. The clock generation apparatus **2301** may have a function of compensating a frequency of an output clock signal by using a compensation function associated with each of a plurality of temperature zones into which a predetermined temperature range is divided. The clock generation apparatus **2301** may have one or more adjustable components, and may have an adjustment mode for adjusting a target component to be adjusted.

(133) The temperature control apparatus **2305** controls temperature of the clock generation apparatus **2301** during adjustment of the clock generation apparatus **2301**. The temperature control apparatus **2305** may have a heater, a cooler, and the like for setting the temperature of the clock generation apparatus **2301** to a target temperature.

(134) The adjustment apparatus **2310** is connected to the clock generation apparatus **2301** such as at the time of inspection before or after shipment of the clock generation apparatus **2301** from a factory, and adjusts the clock generation apparatus **2301**. The adjustment apparatus **2310** may be realized by adding, to a computer, an input/output interface which connects to the clock generation apparatus **2301** and the temperature control apparatus **2305**. Such a computer functions as the adjustment apparatus **2310** by performing an adjustment program for adjusting the clock generation apparatus **2301**. The adjustment apparatus **2310** includes a condition setting unit **2320**, a measurement unit **2340**, an adjustment data decision unit **2360**, and an adjustment data setting unit

2380.

(135) The condition setting unit **2320** sets an adjustment condition (temperature, an adjustment mode, a signal used for adjustment) under which the clock generation apparatus **2301** is adjusted. The condition setting unit **2320** has a temperature setting unit **2325**, a mode setting unit **2330**, and a signal supply unit **2335**. The temperature setting unit **2325** brings the temperature of the clock generation apparatus **2301** to the target temperature by setting the target temperature of the clock generation apparatus **2301** in the temperature control apparatus **2305**.

(136) The mode setting unit **2330** sets, in the clock generation apparatus **2301**, the adjustment mode for adjusting a component to be adjusted which is in the clock generation apparatus **2301**. The signal supply unit **2335** supplies the clock generation apparatus **2301** with a signal used for the adjustment of the clock generation apparatus **2301**.

(137) The measurement unit **2340** measures an operation state of the clock generation apparatus **2301** under the adjustment condition set by the condition setting unit **2320**. The measurement unit **2340** has a digital input unit **2345**, a frequency measurement unit **2350**, and a voltage measurement unit **2355**. The digital input unit **2345** inputs a digital value (digital temperature signal or the like) outputted by a circuit in the clock generation apparatus **2301** in the adjustment mode.

(138) The frequency measurement unit **2350** measures a frequency of a clock signal (output clock signal, internal clock signal outputted in the adjustment mode, or the like) outputted by the clock generation apparatus **2301**. The frequency measurement unit **2350** may measure the frequency of the clock signal by measuring the number of clock pulses outputted by the clock generation apparatus **2301** within a unit time (one second, ten seconds, or the like). Alternatively, the frequency measurement unit **2350** may include a PLL which locks to a phase of a clock outputted by the clock generation apparatus **2301**, and calculate a frequency conversion value from the PLL control signal. The voltage measurement unit **2355** measures a voltage (output voltage of the VDAC **140** or the like) outputted by the clock generation apparatus **2301** in the adjustment mode.

(139) The adjustment data decision unit **2360** decides adjustment data for adjusting the clock generation apparatus **2301**, based on the adjustment condition set by the condition setting unit **2320** and a measurement result from the measurement unit **2340**. The adjustment data decision unit **2360** has a linearity adjustment unit **2365** and a compensation function decision unit **2370**.

(140) The linearity adjustment unit **2365** decides adjustment data for adjusting linearity of an input/output characteristic of a circuit to be adjusted. The compensation function decision unit **2370** decides a compensation function for compensating the frequency of the output clock signal of the clock generation apparatus **2301**.

(141) The adjustment data setting unit **2380** sets, in the clock generation apparatus **2301**, the adjustment data decided by the adjustment data decision unit **2360**. The adjustment data setting unit **2380** has a linearity setting unit **2385** and a compensation function setting unit **2390**.

(142) The linearity setting unit **2385** sets, in the clock generation apparatus **2301**, the adjustment data decided through linearity adjustment by the linearity adjustment unit **2365**. The compensation function setting unit **2390** sets, in the clock generation apparatus **2301**, the adjustment data for temperature compensation decided by the compensation function decision unit **2370**.

(143) FIG. **24** shows an adjustment flow of the clock generation apparatus **2301** by the adjustment apparatus **2310** according to the present embodiment. In **S2400** (step **2400**), the adjustment apparatus **2310** adjusts linearity of a current DAC such as the current DAC **354** included in the second VCO **332** in the clock generation apparatus **2301**.

(144) In **S2410**, the adjustment apparatus **2310** adjusts linearity of a linearity correction circuit such as the linearity correction circuit **1140** included in the digital temperature compensation circuit **1135** in the clock generation apparatus **2301**. In **S2420**, the adjustment apparatus **2310** adjusts linearity of a VDAC such as the VDAC **140** in the clock generation apparatus **2301**. In **S2430**, the adjustment apparatus **2310** adjusts a compensation function of the polynomial circuit **1342**, the polynomial circuit **1442**, the polynomial circuit **1842**, or the like in the clock generation apparatus

2301.

(145) FIG. 25 shows a current DAC adjustment flow of the clock generation apparatus **2301** by the adjustment apparatus **2310** according to the present embodiment. The current DAC adjustment flow shown in the present figure may be performed in S2400 of FIG. 24. The adjustment apparatus **2310** adjust a current DAC in the second VCO **232**, such as the current DAC **354** included in the second VCO **332** in the clock generation apparatus **2301**, in the current DAC adjustment flow shown in the present figure. A case where the adjustment apparatus **2310** adjusts the current DAC **354** will be exemplified below. Note that the current DAC adjustment flow shown in the present figure exemplifies a case where the current DAC **354** is configured to allow a current weighted by $2^{\text{sup}.i}$ to flow for each bit i ($i=0, 1, \dots, I-1$) of an I -bit digital temperature signal.

(146) In S2500, the mode setting unit **2330** in the adjustment apparatus **2310** sets the clock generation apparatus **2301** to a current DAC adjustment mode. The clock generation apparatus **2301** allows reading and writing of an adjustment parameter of the current DAC **354** according to an instruction from the adjustment apparatus **2310** in the current DAC adjustment mode. The clock generation apparatus **2301** is set to input, to the current DAC **354** in the second VCO **332**, a digital temperature signal (or feedback signal) inputted by the signal supply unit **2335** to the clock generation apparatus **2301** instead of a digital temperature signal (or feedback signal) according to a phase difference signal from the phase comparator **234**, in the current DAC adjustment mode. In addition, the clock generation apparatus **2301** is set to output, to an outside of the clock generation apparatus **2301**, an internal clock signal outputted by the second VCO **332**, in the current DAC adjustment mode.

(147) In addition, the clock generation apparatus **2301** may be set to force an analog temperature signal to a fixed value (for example, 1V), in the current DAC adjustment mode. Alternatively, the temperature setting unit **2325** in the adjustment apparatus **2310** may instruct the temperature control apparatus **2305** to bring temperature of the clock generation apparatus **2301** to a predetermined fixed temperature.

(148) In S2510, the signal supply unit **2335** inputs the digital temperature signal of a minimum value (for example, 0) and a maximum value (for example, maximum code value $H=2^{\text{sup}.I}-1$) to the clock generation apparatus **2301**. The frequency measurement unit **2350** measures a frequency $F_{\text{sub}.0}$ of the internal clock signal for a case where the digital temperature signal is minimum and a frequency $F_{\text{sub}.H}$ of the internal clock signal for a case where the digital temperature signal is maximum.

(149) The adjustment apparatus **2310** repeats processing from S2520 to S2550 for each bit of the digital temperature signal. For example, the adjustment apparatus **2310** repeats the processing from S2520 to S2550 for each bit i from the least significant bit to the most significant bit of the digital temperature signal.

(150) The signal supply unit **2335** changes a target bit i of the digital temperature signal, and the frequency measurement unit **2350** measures an amount of change in frequency ΔF of the internal clock signal for a case where the target bit i is changed. For example, if the digital temperature signal is 10 bits and a target bit is a second bit ($i=2$), the signal supply unit **2335** sets the digital temperature signal to $10'b0000000000$ and $10'b0000000100$, and the frequency measurement unit **2350** measures a frequency of the internal clock signal for a case where the digital temperature signal is $10'b0000000000$ and a frequency of the internal clock signal for a case where the digital temperature signal is $10'b0000000100$, to use a difference between these frequencies as the amount of change in frequency ΔF . Note that a plurality of remaining bits other than the target bit i only need to have the same pattern in measurement of the frequencies for a case where the target bit i is 0 and a case where the target bit i is 1, and do not necessarily have to be all 0 or all 1.

(151) In S2540, the linearity adjustment unit **2365** decides the adjustment parameter for the target bit i of the current DAC **354** such that the amount of change in frequency ΔF is the closest to weight of the target bit i . Since an ideal value $\Delta F_{\text{sub}.ideal}$ of the amount of change in frequency

ΔF with the target bit i is $(F_{\text{sub.H}} - F_{\text{sub.0}}) \times (2^{\text{sup.i}} / 2^{\text{sup.I}})$, the linearity adjustment unit **2365** decides the adjustment parameter for weight of a target bit k such that the amount of change in frequency ΔF is brought closer to the ideal value $\Delta F_{\text{sub.ideal}}$, such as by calculating the adjustment parameter obtained by multiplying a current weight of the target bit i by $\Delta F_{\text{sub.ideal}} / \Delta F$.

(152) The adjustment apparatus **2310** repeats the processing from **S2520** to **S2550** until processing has been completed for all bits of the digital temperature signal. After the repetitive processing is completed, in **S2560**, the linearity setting unit **2385** writes adjustment data including the adjustment parameter for weight of each bit to the adjustment data storage unit **150**, thereby setting it in the clock generation apparatus **2301**.

(153) Note that various other methods may be adopted as a method of deciding the adjustment parameter for each target bit i . For example, the signal supply unit **2335** may adjust the weight of the target bit i such that the amount of change in frequency ΔF for the time when the digital temperature signal (for example, $10'b0000000100$) in which only the target bit i is 1 and the other bits are 0 and the digital temperature signal obtained by subtracting 1 from this value (for example, $10'b0000000011$) are inputted to the clock generation apparatus **2301** is an ideal amount of change in frequency for the time when the digital temperature signal changes by 1.

(154) FIG. **26** shows an example of linearity of digital temperature signals. The horizontal axis of the present figure represents temperature indicated by an analog temperature signal from the temperature sensor **125**, and the vertical axis represents an average code value of the digital temperature signal. A solid-line graph labeled “with element variation of DC-VCO” indicates a state in which weight of each bit of the current DAC **354** in the second VCO **332** varies and the linearity of the digital temperature signal with respect to the temperature is low.

(155) If the linearity of the digital temperature signal with respect to the temperature is low, the digital temperature signal cannot be represented by a linear function of the temperature, and will include a component of a second or higher order of the temperature. In this case, when the polynomial circuit **1342**, the polynomial circuit **1442**, the polynomial circuit **1842**, or another polynomial circuit **1142** calculates a digital temperature compensation signal by using an N -th order polynomial, a higher-order component of an $(N+1)$ -th or higher order of the temperature is mixed into the digital temperature compensation signal, and a frequency error is generated in temperature compensation by the digital temperature compensation signal.

(156) A dashed-line graph labeled “without element variation of DC-VCO” of the present figure indicates a state in which the digital temperature signal has high linearity with respect to the temperature as a result of adjusting the weight of each bit of the current DAC **354** in the second VCO **332**. The adjustment apparatus **2310** can adjust each adjustment parameter of the current DAC **354**, thereby reducing generation of the frequency error involved with the higher-order component of the $(N+1)$ -th or higher order being mixed into the digital temperature compensation signal.

(157) FIG. **27** shows a linearity correction circuit adjustment flow of the clock generation apparatus **2301** by the adjustment apparatus **2310** according to the present embodiment. The linearity correction circuit adjustment flow shown in the present figure may be performed in **S2410** of FIG. **24**. Adjustment according to the current DAC adjustment flow shown in FIG. **25** adjusts linearity of a frequency of an internal clock signal with respect to a digital temperature signal. In contrast, the linearity correction circuit adjustment flow in the present figure adjusts the linearity of the digital temperature signal with respect to temperature. In the linearity correction circuit adjustment flow shown in the present figure, the adjustment apparatus **2310** adjusts the linearity correction circuit **1140** included in the digital temperature compensation circuit **1135**, such as the linearity correction circuit **1240** in the clock generation apparatus **2301**. A case where the adjustment apparatus **2310** adjusts the linearity correction circuit **1240** will be exemplified below.

(158) In **S2700**, the mode setting unit **2330** in the adjustment apparatus **2310** sets the clock

generation apparatus **2301** to a linearity correction circuit adjustment mode. The clock generation apparatus **2301** allows reading and writing of an adjustment parameter of the linearity correction circuit **1240** according to an instruction from the adjustment apparatus **2310** in the linearity correction circuit adjustment mode. The clock generation apparatus **2301** is set to output, to an outside of the clock generation apparatus **2301**, the digital temperature signal outputted by the TADC **230**, in the linearity correction circuit adjustment mode.

(159) In **S2710**, the temperature setting unit **2325** controls the temperature control apparatus **2305**, to set actual temperature of the clock generation apparatus **2301** to various temperatures within a temperature compensation range. The digital input unit **2345** obtains, from the clock generation apparatus **2301**, the digital temperature signal outputted by the linearity correction circuit **1240** in the clock generation apparatus **2301** at each actual temperature.

(160) In **S2720**, the linearity adjustment unit **2365** calculates each adjustment parameter of the linearity correction circuit **1240** for linearly correcting the digital temperature signal, by using a value of the digital temperature signal at each actual temperature. For example, the linearity adjustment unit **2365** may calculate, by using a least squares method or the like, an approximate curve (if a correction function is a cubic polynomial, an approximate function of a cubic function) for converting each value of the digital temperature signal outputted by the TADC **230** to a value indicating corresponding actual temperature, to use a gain $P_{sub.1}$, $P_{sub.2}$, $P_{sub.3}$, or the like of each dimension in the approximate curve as the adjustment parameter. In **S2730**, the linearity setting unit **2385** writes adjustment data including each calculated adjustment parameter to the adjustment data storage unit **150**, thereby setting it in the linearity correction circuit **1240** in the clock generation apparatus **2301**.

(161) FIG. **28A** shows an example of a frequency error characteristic of a digital temperature signal.

(162) FIG. **28B** shows an example of a frequency error characteristic of a digital temperature signal after linearity correction of the linearity correction circuit **1140**. The horizontal axes in these figures represent temperature indicated by an analog temperature signal from the temperature sensor **125**, and the vertical axes represent an error of the digital temperature signal (average) with respect to the temperature indicated by the analog temperature signal.

(163) As described with reference to FIG. **26**, if the digital temperature signal does not have linearity with respect to the temperature, a higher-order component of an $(N+1)$ -th or higher order of the temperature is mixed into the digital temperature compensation signal, and a frequency error is generated in temperature compensation by the digital temperature compensation signal. The adjustment apparatus **2310** can adjust the linearity correction circuit **1140**, thereby increasing the linearity of the digital temperature signal with respect to the temperature and reducing the frequency error of an output clock signal after the temperature compensation. Note that the clock generation apparatus **1** and the adjustment apparatus **2310** may be able to perform only either the adjustment in FIG. **25** or the adjustment in FIG. **27**.

(164) FIG. **29** shows a VDAC adjustment flow of the clock generation apparatus **2301** by the adjustment apparatus **2310** according to the present embodiment. The VDAC adjustment flow shown in the present figure may be performed in **S2420** of FIG. **24**. The adjustment apparatus **2310** adjusts a voltage DAC such as the VDAC **140** in the clock generation apparatus **2301**, in the VDAC adjustment flow shown in the present figure. A case where the adjustment apparatus **2310** adjusts the VDAC **140** will be exemplified below. Note that the VDAC adjustment flow shown in the present figure exemplifies a case where the VDAC **140** is configured to output a voltage weighted by $2^{sup.p}$, for each bit p ($p=0, 1, \dots, P-1$) of a P -bit digital temperature compensation signal.

(165) In **S2900**, the mode setting unit **2330** in the adjustment apparatus **2310** sets the clock generation apparatus **2301** to a VDAC adjustment mode. The clock generation apparatus **2301** allows reading and writing of an adjustment parameter of the VDAC **140** according to an

instruction from the adjustment apparatus **2310** in the VDAC adjustment mode. The clock generation apparatus **2301** is set to input, to the VDAC **140**, a digital temperature compensation signal inputted by the signal supply unit **2335** to the clock generation apparatus **2301** instead of a digital temperature compensation signal from the digital temperature compensation circuit **135**, in the VDAC adjustment mode. In addition, the clock generation apparatus **2301** is set to output, to an outside of the clock generation apparatus **2301**, an analog temperature compensation signal outputted by the VDAC **140**, in the VDAC adjustment mode. In addition, the clock generation apparatus **2301** may cut off connection between the analog temperature compensation circuit **160** and the LPF **145** in the VDAC adjustment mode.

(166) In **S2910**, the signal supply unit **2335** inputs the digital temperature compensation signal of a minimum value (for example, 0) and a maximum value (for example, maximum code value $Q=2^{\text{sup.p}}-1$) to the clock generation apparatus **2301**. The voltage measurement unit **2355** measures a voltage $V_{\text{sub.0}}$ of the analog temperature compensation signal outputted by the VDAC **140** if the digital temperature compensation signal is the minimum value and a voltage $V_{\text{sub.Q}}$ of the analog temperature compensation signal outputted by the VDAC **140** if the digital temperature compensation signal is the maximum value.

(167) The adjustment apparatus **2310** repeats processing from **S2920** to **S2950** for each bit of the digital temperature compensation signal. For example, the adjustment apparatus **2310** repeats the processing from **S2920** to **S2950** for each bit p from the least significant bit to the most significant bit of the digital temperature compensation signal.

(168) In **S2930**, the voltage measurement unit **2355** measures an amount of change in voltage ΔV of the digital temperature compensation signal for a case where a target bit p of the digital temperature compensation signal is changed. For example, if the digital temperature signal is 5 bits and a target bit is a second bit ($p=2$), the signal supply unit **2335** sets the digital temperature compensation signal to $5'b00000$ and $5'b00100$, and the voltage measurement unit **2355** measures a voltage of the analog temperature compensation signal for a case where the digital temperature compensation signal is $5'b00000$ and a voltage of the analog temperature compensation signal for a case where the digital temperature compensation signal is $5'b00100$, to use a difference between these voltages as the amount of change in voltage ΔV . Note that a plurality of remaining bits other than the target bit p only need to have the same pattern in measurement of the frequencies for a case where the target bit p is 0 and a case where the target bit i is 1, and do not necessarily have to be all 0 or all 1.

(169) In **S2940**, the linearity adjustment unit **2365** decides the adjustment parameter for the target bit p of the current DAC **354** such that the amount of change in voltage ΔV is the closest to weight of the target bit p . Since an ideal value $\Delta V_{\text{sub.ideal}}$ of the amount of change in voltage ΔV of the target bit p is $(V_{\text{sub.Q}}-V_{\text{sub.0}}) \times (2^{\text{sup.p}}/2^{\text{sup.p}})$, the linearity adjustment unit **2365** decides the adjustment parameter for the weight of the target bit p such that the amount of change in voltage ΔV is brought closer to the ideal value $\Delta V_{\text{sub.ideal}}$, such as by calculating the adjustment parameter obtained by multiplying a current weight of the target bit p by $\Delta V_{\text{sub.ideal}}/\Delta V$.

(170) The adjustment apparatus **2310** repeats the processing from **S2920** to **S2950** until processing has been completed for all bits of the digital temperature compensation signal. After the repetitive processing is completed, in **S2960**, the linearity setting unit **2385** writes adjustment data including the adjustment parameter for weight of each bit to the adjustment data storage unit **150**, thereby setting it in the clock generation apparatus **2301**.

(171) The adjustment apparatus **2310** can reduce an error of a control voltage supplied to the first VCO **120** according to the digital temperature compensation signal outputted by the digital temperature compensation circuit **135**, by adjusting linearity of the voltage DAC such as the VDAC **140**. As a result, the adjustment apparatus **2310** can reduce a frequency error of an output clock signal after temperature compensation.

(172) FIG. **30** shows a compensation function adjustment flow of the clock generation apparatus

2301 by the adjustment apparatus **2310** according to the present embodiment. The compensation function adjustment flow shown in the present figure may be performed in **S2430** of FIG. **24**.
(173) In **S3000**, the mode setting unit **2330** in the adjustment apparatus **2310** sets the clock generation apparatus **2301** to a compensation function adjustment mode. The clock generation apparatus **2301** may allow reading and writing of an adjustment parameter related to a compensation function according to an instruction from the adjustment apparatus **2310** in the compensation function adjustment mode.

(174) In **S3010**, the temperature setting unit **2325** controls the temperature control apparatus **2305**, to set actual temperature of the clock generation apparatus **2301** to various temperatures within a temperature compensation range. The frequency measurement unit **2350** measures a frequency of an output clock signal outputted by the clock generation apparatus **2301** at each actual temperature.

(175) In **S3020**, the compensation function decision unit **2370** calculates a value of a digital temperature compensation signal (a compensation value) for compensating an error of the frequency of the output clock signal at each actual temperature (a difference from a target frequency independent of temperature). The compensation function decision unit **2370** may store in advance a frequency increment (design value or measurement value) of the output clock signal for each time the digital temperature compensation signal increases by a unit amount (for example, +1), and decide an amount by which the digital temperature compensation signal should be increased or decreased in order to compensate a frequency error at each actual temperature. Alternatively, the compensation function decision unit **2370** may adjust an offset value to be added to the digital temperature compensation signal such that the frequency of the output clock signal is the target frequency at each actual temperature, and decide this offset value as an amount to be added to the digital temperature compensation signal at each actual temperature. As a result, the compensation function decision unit **2370** can obtain an ideal value of the digital temperature compensation signal at each actual temperature.

(176) The adjustment apparatus **2310** repeats processing from **S3030** to **S3050** for each temperature zone. In **S3040**, the compensation function decision unit **2370** decides the compensation function for each of a plurality of temperature zones. For each temperature zone, the compensation function decision unit **2370** may calculate, by using a least squares method or the like, an approximate curve (if the compensation function is a quintic polynomial, an approximate function of a quintic function) for converting a digital temperature signal indicating each actual temperature to a value as close as possible to the ideal value of the digital temperature compensation signal at each actual temperature, to use a gain $G_{sub.1}$, $G_{sub.2}$, . . . , $G_{sub.N}$, or the like of each dimension in the approximate curve as the adjustment parameter of the compensation function.

(177) When the processing from **S3030** to **S3050** has been completed for all temperature zones, the compensation function decision unit **2370** decides, in **S3060**, adjustment parameters including a frequency correction amount and target temperature of correction by the lookup table **1850** for temperature of a boundary portion between the temperature zones. The compensation function decision unit **2370** may use, as a target of the correction by the lookup table **1850**, a point where the value of the digital temperature compensation signal by the compensation function has an error equal to or greater than a threshold from the ideal value, within a predetermined temperature range (for example, ± 2 degrees C.) from the boundary between the temperature zones. In **S3070**, the compensation function setting unit **2390** writes, to the adjustment data storage unit **150**, adjustment data including the compensation function corresponding to each of the plurality of temperature zones and each setting parameter to be set in the lookup table **1850**, thereby setting it in the clock generation apparatus **2301**.

(178) FIG. **31** shows an example of a frequency error characteristic after digital temperature compensation. The horizontal axis of the present figure represents temperature, and the vertical axis represents a frequency error (ppb) of an output clock signal. The frequency error characteristic in the present figure indicates, for each of the five temperature zones shown in FIG. **15**, the

frequency error of the output clock signal for a case where a compensation function generated by using an ideal value of a digital temperature compensation signal in the temperature zone is used. (179) FIG. 32A shows an example of a frequency temperature slope after digital temperature compensation. The horizontal axis of the present figure represents temperature, and the vertical axis represents a frequency temperature slope of an output clock signal. The frequency temperature slope shown in the present figure indicates a gradient between two adjacent temperature points (an amount of change in a frequency error per 1 degree C. of temperature) in FIG. 31, and corresponds to differentiation of a frequency error characteristic in FIG. 31. As shown in FIG. 32A, when a compensation function is generated, for each temperature zone, by using an ideal value of a digital temperature compensation signal in the temperature zone, compensation functions of adjacent temperature zones become discontinuous, which may result in an absolute value of the frequency temperature slope increasing at a boundary portion between the temperature zones. The frequency temperature slope indicates an amount of change in frequency for a case where ambient temperature suddenly changes, and is desired to be gentle.

(180) FIG. 32B shows an example of a frequency temperature slope after digital temperature compensation for a case where a compensation function is decided by overlapping each zone. The horizontal axis of the present figure represents temperature, and the vertical axis represents a frequency temperature slope of an output clock signal.

(181) In the example of the present figure, the compensation function decision unit 2370 decides, for each of a plurality of temperature zones, the compensation function by using a zone defined to partially overlap with an adjacent temperature zone. Specifically, in the example of the present figure, for each temperature zone, the compensation function decision unit 2370 extends a boundary of the temperature zone by ± 2 degrees C. (extends a lower limit of the temperature zone by -2 degrees C., and extends an upper limit of the temperature zone by $+2$ degrees C.), and generates the compensation function by using an ideal value of a digital temperature compensation signal included in the extended zone. For the temperature zone 3 from $+18$ degrees C. to $+47$ degrees C. for example, the compensation function decision unit 2370 generates the compensation function ranging from $+16$ degrees C. to $+49$ degrees C. by using an ideal value of a digital temperature signal included in the zone from $+16$ degrees C. to $+49$ degrees C., so that the generated compensation function is used in a temperature range from $+18$ degrees C. to $+47$ degrees C.

(182) The adjustment apparatus 2310 can decide, for each temperature zone, the compensation function by using the zone partially overlapping with the adjacent temperature zone, thereby reducing an absolute value of the frequency temperature slope at the boundary of the temperature zone, as shown in FIG. 32B. As a result, the adjustment apparatus 2310 can reduce discontinuity generated in a frequency error characteristic of the output clock signal at the boundary of the temperature zone.

(183) Various embodiments of the present invention may be described with reference to flowcharts and block diagrams whose blocks may represent (1) stages of processes in which operations are performed or (2) sections of apparatuses responsible for performing operations. Certain stages and sections may be implemented by dedicated circuit, programmable circuit supplied with computer readable instructions stored on computer readable media, and/or processors supplied with computer readable instructions stored on computer readable media. Dedicated circuit may include digital and/or analog hardware circuits, and may include integrated circuits (IC) and/or discrete circuits. The programmable circuit may include a reconfigurable hardware circuit including logical AND, logical OR, logical XOR, logical NAND, logical NOR, and other logical operations, a memory element such as a flip-flop, a register, a field programmable gate array (FPGA) and a programmable logic array (PLA), and the like.

(184) A computer readable medium may include any tangible device that can store instructions to be executed by a suitable device, and as a result, the computer readable medium having instructions

stored thereon includes an article of manufacture including instructions which can be executed in order to create means for performing operations designated in the flowcharts or block diagrams. Examples of the computer readable medium may include an electronic storage medium, a magnetic storage medium, an optical storage medium, an electromagnetic storage medium, a semiconductor storage medium, and the like. More specific examples of the computer readable medium may include a floppy (registered trademark) disk, a diskette, a hard disk, a random access memory (RAM), a read-only memory (ROM), an erasable programmable read-only memory (EPROM or flash memory), an electrically erasable programmable read-only memory (EEPROM), a fuse, a static random access memory (SRAM), a compact disc read-only memory (CD-ROM), a digital versatile disk (DVD), a Blu-ray (registered trademark) disk, a memory stick, an integrated circuit card, and the like.

(185) The computer readable instruction may include: an assembler instruction, an instruction-set-architecture (ISA) instruction; a machine instruction; a machine dependent instruction; a microcode; a firmware instruction; state-setting data; or either a source code or an object code described in any combination of one or more programming languages, including an object oriented programming language such as Smalltalk (registered trademark), JAVA (registered trademark), C++, Python, or the like; and a conventional procedural programming language such as a “C” programming language or a similar programming language.

(186) The computer readable instructions may be provided for a processor or programmable circuit of a general purpose computer, special purpose computer, or other programmable data processing apparatuses such as a computer locally or via a wide area network (WAN) such as a local area network (LAN), the Internet, or the like, and execute the computer readable instructions in order to create means for executing the operations designated in flowcharts or block diagrams. Examples of the processor include a computer processor, a processing unit, a microprocessor, a digital signal processor, a controller, a microcontroller, and the like.

(187) FIG. 33 shows an example of a computer **2200** in which a plurality of aspects of the present invention may be entirely or partially embodied. A program installed in the computer **2200** may cause the computer **2200** to function as an operation associated with the apparatuses according to the embodiments of the present invention or as one or more sections of the apparatuses, or may cause the operation or the one or more sections to be executed, and/or may cause the computer **2200** to execute a process according to the embodiments of the present invention or a stage of the process. Such programs may be executed by a CPU **2212** in order to cause the computer **2200** to perform certain operations associated with some or all of the blocks in the flowcharts and block diagrams described in the present specification.

(188) The computer **2200** according to the present embodiment includes the CPU **2212**, a RAM **2214**, a graphics controller **2216**, and a display device **2218**, which are mutually connected by a host controller **2210**. The computer **2200** also includes input/output units such as a communication interface **2222**, a hard disk drive **2224**, a DVD-ROM drive **2226**, and an IC card drive, which are connected to the host controller **2210** via an input/output controller **2220**. The computer also includes legacy input/output units such as a ROM **2230** and a keyboard **2242**, which are connected to the input/output controller **2220** via an input/output chip **2240**.

(189) The CPU **2212** operates according to programs stored in the ROM **2230** and the RAM **2214**, thereby controlling each unit. The graphics controller **2216** obtains image data generated by the CPU **2212** on a frame buffer or the like provided in the RAM **2214** or in itself, and causes the image data to be displayed on the display device **2218**.

(190) The communication interface **2222** communicates with other electronic devices via a network. The hard disk drive **2224** stores programs and data used by the CPU **2212** in the computer **2200**. The DVD-ROM drive **2226** reads the programs or the data from the DVD-ROM **2201**, and provides the hard disk drive **2224** with the programs or the data via the RAM **2214**. The IC card drive reads the programs and the data from the IC card, and/or writes the programs and the data to

the IC card.

(191) The ROM **2230** stores therein boot programs and the like executed by the computer **2200** at the time of activation, and/or programs that depend on the hardware of the computer **2200**. The input/output chip **2240** may also connect various input/output units to the input/output controller **2220** via a parallel port, a serial port, a keyboard port, a mouse port, and the like.

(192) The program is provided by a computer readable medium such as the DVD-ROM **2201** or the IC card. The program is read from a computer readable medium, installed in the hard disk drive **2224**, the RAM **2214**, or the ROM **2230** which are also examples of the computer readable medium, and executed by the CPU **2212**. The information processing described in these programs is read by the computer **2200** and provides cooperation between the programs and the above-described various types of hardware resources. The apparatus or method may be configured by realizing operations or processing of information according to use of the computer **2200**.

(193) For example, in a case where communication is performed between the computer **2200** and an external device, the CPU **2212** may execute a communication program loaded in the RAM **2214** and instruct the communication interface **2222** to perform communication processing based on processing described in the communication program. Under the control of the CPU **2212**, the communication interface **2222** reads transmission data stored in a transmission buffer processing region provided in a recording medium such as the RAM **2214**, the hard disk drive **2224**, the DVD-ROM **2201**, or the IC card, transmits the read transmission data to the network, or writes reception data received from the network in a reception buffer processing region or the like provided on the recording medium.

(194) In addition, the CPU **2212** may cause the RAM **2214** to read all or a necessary part of a file or database stored in an external recording medium such as the hard disk drive **2224**, the DVD-ROM drive **2226** (DVD-ROM **2201**), the IC card, or the like, and may execute various types of processing on data on the RAM **2214**. Next, the CPU **2212** writes back the processed data to the external recording medium.

(195) Various types of information such as various types of programs, data, tables, and databases may be stored in a recording medium and subjected to information processing. The CPU **2212** may execute various types of processing on the data read from the RAM **2214** to write back a result to the RAM **2214**, the processing being described throughout the present disclosure, designated by instruction sequences of the programs, and including various types of operations, information processing, condition determinations, conditional branching, unconditional branching, information searches/replacements, or the like. In addition, the CPU **2212** may search for information in a file, a database, etc., in the recording medium. For example, when a plurality of entries, each having an attribute value of a first attribute associated with an attribute value of a second attribute, are stored in the recording medium, the CPU **2212** may search for an entry matching the condition whose attribute value of the first attribute is designated, from among the plurality of entries, and read the attribute value of the second attribute stored in the entry, thereby obtaining the attribute value of the second attribute associated with the first attribute satisfying the predetermined condition.

(196) The programs or software modules described above may be stored in a computer readable medium on or near the computer **2200**. In addition, a recording medium such as a hard disk or a RAM provided in a server system connected to a dedicated communication network or the Internet can be used as a computer readable medium, thereby providing a program to the computer **2200** via the network.

(197) While the present invention has been described with the embodiments, the technical scope of the present invention is not limited to the scope described in the above-described embodiments. It is apparent to persons skilled in the art that diverse alterations or improvements can be made to the above-described embodiments. It is apparent from the description of the claims that embodiments added with such alterations or improvements can also be included in the technical scope of the present invention.

(198) While the present invention has been described with the embodiments, the technical scope of the present invention is not limited to the scope described in the above-described embodiments. It is apparent to persons skilled in the art that diverse alterations or improvements can be made to the above-described embodiments. It is apparent from the description of the claims that embodiments added with such alterations or improvements can also be included in the technical scope of the present invention.

(199) It should be noted that the operations, procedures, steps, stages, and the like of each process performed by an apparatus, system, program, and method shown in the claims, embodiments, or diagrams can be realized in any order as long as the order is not indicated by “prior to,” “before,” or the like and as long as the output from a previous process is not used in a later process. Even if the operation flow is described using phrases such as “first” or “next” in the claims, embodiments, or diagrams for convenience, it does not necessarily mean that the process must be performed in this order.

EXPLANATION OF REFERENCES

(200) **1**: clock generation apparatus, **100**: oven, **105**: resonator, **110**: temperature sensor, **115**: heater, **120**: first VCO, **125**: temperature sensor, **130**: TADC, **135**: digital temperature compensation circuit, **140**: VDAC, **145**: LPF, **150**: adjustment data storage unit, **160**: analog temperature compensation circuit, **170**: oven control circuit, **175**: resonator temperature detector, **180**: target temperature signal generator, **190**: differential amplifier, **195**: heater driving circuit, **230**: TADC, **232**: second VCO, **234**: phase comparator, **236**: loop filter, **332**: second VCO, **340**: ring oscillator, **350**: power supply current generator, **352**: FET, **354**: current DAC, **356**: differential amplifier, **358**: FET, **634**: phase comparator, **640**: binary converter, **834**: phase comparator, **842**: lock detection circuit, **844**: frequency detection circuit, **846**: counter, **848**: counter, **850**: frequency comparison circuit, **852**: comparator, **854**: amplifier, **856**: comparator, **858**: amplifier, **860**: adder, **862**: selection circuit, **936**: loop filter, **940**: amplifier, **942**: delay element, **944**: amplifier, **946**: integrator, **948**: adder, **1036**: loop filter, **1135**: digital temperature compensation circuit, **1140**: linearity correction circuit, **1142**: polynomial circuit, **1144**: delta-sigma modulator, **1240**: linearity correction circuit, **1250**: exponentiator, **1252**: amplifier, **1254**: adder, **1342**: polynomial circuit, **1350**: exponentiator, **1352**: amplifier, **1354**: adder, **1442**: polynomial circuit, **1450**: temperature zone selection circuit, **1452**: function generation circuit, **1454**: temperature shift circuit, **1842**: polynomial circuit, **1850**: lookup table, **1852**: storage region, **1854**: correction amount selection circuit, **2030**: TADC, **2038**: delta-sigma modulator, **2130**: TADC, **2140**: dither application circuit, **2180**: TADC, **2301**: clock generation apparatus, **2305**: temperature control apparatus, **2310**: adjustment apparatus, **2320**: condition setting unit, **2325**: temperature setting unit, **2330**: mode setting unit, **2335**: signal supply unit, **2340**: measurement unit, **2345**: digital input unit, **2350**: frequency measurement unit, **2355**: voltage measurement unit, **2360**: adjustment data decision unit, **2365**: linearity adjustment unit, **2370**: compensation function decision unit, **2380**: adjustment data setting unit, **2385**: linearity setting unit, **2390**: compensation function setting unit, **2200**: computer, **2201**: DVD-ROM, **2210**: host controller, **2212**: CPU, **2214**: RAM, **2216**: graphics controller, **2218**: display device, **2220**: input/output controller, **2222**: communication interface, **2224**: hard disk drive, **2226**: DVD-ROM drive, **2230**: ROM, **2240**: input/output chip, **2242**: keyboard.

Claims

1. A clock generation apparatus which generates an output clock signal, comprising: a first voltage-controlled oscillator which outputs the output clock signal; an AD converter which includes: a second voltage-controlled oscillator which outputs an internal clock signal phase-locked to the output clock signal in response to a digital temperature signal having become a value corresponding to an analog temperature signal from a temperature sensor; a phase comparator which detects a phase difference between the output clock signal and the internal clock signal; and

a digital temperature signal generator which generates the digital temperature signal according to the phase difference detected by the phase comparator, to output it to the second voltage-controlled oscillator; and a digital temperature compensation circuit which compensates a frequency of the output clock signal of the first voltage-controlled oscillator by using the digital temperature signal; wherein the digital temperature compensation circuit compensates the frequency of the output clock signal by using a compensation function associated with each of a plurality of temperature zones into which a predetermined temperature range is divided, and the digital temperature compensation circuit controls the frequency of the output clock signal of the first voltage-controlled oscillator by using a temperature compensation value stored in a lookup table, in response to the digital temperature signal indicating temperature of a boundary portion between the temperature zones.

2. The clock generation apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the second voltage-controlled oscillator outputs the internal clock signal with a frequency according to the analog temperature signal and the phase difference detected by the phase comparator.

3. The clock generation apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the second voltage-controlled oscillator includes a ring oscillator which oscillates at a frequency according to a difference between temperature designated by the analog temperature signal and temperature designated by the digital temperature signal.

4. The clock generation apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the AD converter includes: a determination circuit which determines whether the phase difference detected by the phase comparator has come out of a predetermined range; a frequency detection circuit which detects frequencies of the output clock signal and the internal clock signal in response to the phase difference detected by the phase comparator having come out of the predetermined range; and a selection circuit which selects the phase difference detected by the phase comparator in response to the phase difference detected by the phase comparator falling within the predetermined range, and selects a phase difference decided according to a result of comparing a frequency equivalent to an integer multiple of the frequency of the output clock signal with the frequency of the internal clock signal in response to the phase difference detected by the phase comparator having come out of the predetermined range, and the second voltage-controlled oscillator outputs the internal clock signal with a frequency according to the analog temperature signal and the phase difference selected by the selection circuit.

5. The clock generation apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the AD converter includes a first delta-sigma modulator which modulates a signal which is based on a phase difference signal according to the phase difference between the output clock signal and the internal clock signal, to output it to the second voltage-controlled oscillator.

6. The clock generation apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the AD converter further includes a dither application circuit which applies dither to a signal which is based on a phase difference signal according to the phase difference between the output clock signal and the internal clock signal, to output the signal to the second voltage-controlled oscillator.

7. The clock generation apparatus according to claim 1, further comprising an analog temperature compensation circuit which compensates the frequency of the output clock signal of the first voltage-controlled oscillator according to the analog temperature signal, wherein the digital temperature compensation circuit compensates a frequency error of the output clock signal, which remains even after temperature compensation by the analog temperature compensation circuit.

8. The clock generation apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the digital temperature compensation circuit includes: a temperature zone selection circuit which selects a temperature zone to be used from among the plurality of temperature zones according to the digital temperature signal; and a function generation circuit which generates the compensation function which uses a parameter according to the temperature zone selected by the temperature zone selection circuit, and the digital temperature compensation circuit controls the frequency of the output clock signal of the

first voltage-controlled oscillator by using the compensation function generated by the function generation circuit.

9. The clock generation apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the digital temperature compensation circuit includes a linear correction circuit which linearly corrects the digital temperature signal.

10. The clock generation apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the first voltage-controlled oscillator generates the output clock signal by using a crystal resonator, a MEMS resonator, or a langasite type resonator, and the second voltage-controlled oscillator generates the internal clock signal by using a PLL.

11. The clock generation apparatus according to claim 10, wherein the crystal resonator, the MEMS resonator, or the langasite type resonator is provided outside a semiconductor chip containing the AD converter and the digital temperature compensation circuit.

12. The clock generation apparatus according to claim 10, further comprising an oven control circuit which controls temperature of the crystal resonator, the MEMS resonator, or the langasite type resonator to be kept constant.

13. A clock generation method for generating an output clock signal, comprising: a first voltage-controlled oscillator outputs the output clock signal; an AD converter outputs, with a second voltage-controlled oscillator, an internal clock signal phase-locked to the output clock signal in response to a digital temperature signal having become a value corresponding to an analog temperature signal from a temperature sensor, detects a phase difference between the output clock signal and the internal clock signal, and generates the digital temperature signal according to the phase difference which has been detected, to output it to the second voltage-controlled oscillator; and a digital temperature compensation circuit compensates a frequency of the output clock signal of the first voltage-controlled oscillator by using the digital temperature signal; wherein the digital temperature compensation circuit compensates the frequency of the output clock signal by using a compensation function associated with each of a plurality of temperature zones into which a predetermined temperature range is divided, and the digital temperature compensation circuit controls the frequency of the output clock signal of the first voltage-controlled oscillator by using a temperature compensation value stored in a lookup table, in response to the digital temperature signal indicating temperature of a boundary portion between the temperature zones.

14. The clock generation method according to claim 13, wherein the second voltage-controlled oscillator outputs the internal clock signal with a frequency according to the analog temperature signal and the phase difference which has been detected.

15. The clock generation method according to claim 14, wherein the second voltage-controlled oscillator includes a ring oscillator which oscillates at a frequency according to a difference between temperature designated by the analog temperature signal and temperature designated by the digital temperature signal.

16. A clock generation apparatus which generates an output clock signal, comprising: a first voltage-controlled oscillator which outputs the output clock signal; an AD converter which includes: a second voltage-controlled oscillator which outputs an internal clock signal phase-locked to the output clock signal in response to a digital temperature signal having become a value corresponding to an analog temperature signal from a temperature sensor; a phase comparator which detects a phase difference between the output clock signal and the internal clock signal; and a digital temperature signal generator which generates the digital temperature signal according to the phase difference detected by the phase comparator, to output it to the second voltage-controlled oscillator; and a digital temperature compensation circuit which compensates a frequency of the output clock signal of the first voltage-controlled oscillator by using the digital temperature signal, wherein the digital temperature compensation circuit includes a function generation circuit that generates an N-th order compensation function from the digital temperature signal using an adjustment parameter stored in a storage unit, and the digital temperature compensation circuit

controls the frequency of the output clock signal of the first voltage-controlled oscillator by using the generated compensation function.

17. The clock generation apparatus according to claim 16, wherein the second voltage-controlled oscillator outputs the internal clock signal with a frequency according to the analog temperature signal and the phase difference detected by the phase comparator.

18. The clock generation apparatus according to claim 16, wherein the second voltage-controlled oscillator includes a ring oscillator which oscillates at a frequency according to a difference between temperature designated by the analog temperature signal and temperature designated by the digital temperature signal.

19. The clock generation apparatus according to claim 16, wherein the AD converter includes: a determination circuit which determines whether the phase difference detected by the phase comparator has come out of a predetermined range; a frequency detection circuit which detects frequencies of the output clock signal and the internal clock signal in response to the phase difference detected by the phase comparator having come out of the predetermined range; and a selection circuit which selects the phase difference detected by the phase comparator in response to the phase difference detected by the phase comparator falling within the predetermined range, and selects a phase difference decided according to a result of comparing a frequency equivalent to an integer multiple of the frequency of the output clock signal with the frequency of the internal clock signal in response to the phase difference detected by the phase comparator having come out of the predetermined range, and the second voltage-controlled oscillator outputs the internal clock signal with a frequency according to the analog temperature signal and the phase difference selected by the selection circuit.

20. The clock generation apparatus according to claim 16, wherein the AD converter includes a first delta-sigma modulator which modulates a signal which is based on a phase difference signal according to the phase difference between the output clock signal and the internal clock signal, to output it to the second voltage-controlled oscillator.
